

EQUILIBRIUM

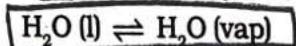
Objectives

After studying this unit you will be able to :

- identify dynamic nature of equilibrium involved in physical and chemical processes;
- state the law of equilibrium;
- explain characteristics of equilibria involved in physical and chemical processes;
- write expressions for equilibrium constants;
- establish a relationship between K_p and K_c ;
- explain various factors that affect the equilibrium state of a reaction;
- classify substances as acids or bases according to Arrhenius, Bronsted-Lowry and Lewis concepts;
- classify acids and bases as weak or strong in terms of their ionization constants;
- explain the dependence of degree of ionization on concentration of the electrolyte and that of the common ion;
- describe pH scale for representing hydrogen ion concentration;
- explain ionisation of water and its dual role as acid and base;
- describe ionic product (K_w) and pK_w for water;
- appreciate use of buffer solutions;
- calculate solubility product constant.

Chemical equilibria are important in numerous biological and environmental processes. For example, equilibria involving O_2 molecules and the protein hemoglobin play a crucial role in the transport and delivery of O_2 from our lungs to our muscles. Similar equilibria involving CO molecules and hemoglobin account for the toxicity of CO.

When a liquid evaporates in a closed container, molecules with relatively higher kinetic energy escape the liquid surface into the vapour phase and number of liquid molecules from the vapour phase strike the liquid surface and are retained in the liquid phase. It gives rise to a constant vapour pressure because of an equilibrium in which the number of molecules leaving the liquid equals the number returning to liquid from the vapour. We say that the system has reached **equilibrium state** at this stage. However, this is not static equilibrium and there is a lot of activity at the boundary between the liquid and the vapour. Thus, at equilibrium, the rate of evaporation is equal to the rate of condensation. It may be represented by



The double half arrows indicate that the processes in both the directions are going on simultaneously. The mixture of reactants and products in the equilibrium state is called an **equilibrium mixture**.

Equilibrium can be established for both physical processes and chemical reactions. The reaction may be fast or slow depending on the experimental conditions and the nature of the reactants. When the reactants in a closed vessel at a particular temperature react to give products, the concentrations of the reactants keep on decreasing, while those of products keep on increasing for some time after which there is no change in the concentrations of either of the reactants or products. This stage of the system is the **dynamic equilibrium** and the rates of the forward and

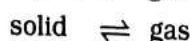
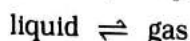
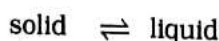
reverse reactions become equal. It is due to this dynamic equilibrium stage that there is no change in the concentrations of various species in the reaction mixture. Based on the extent to which the reactions proceed to reach the state of **chemical equilibrium**, these may be classified in three groups.

- (i) The reactions that proceed nearly to completion and only negligible concentrations of the reactants are left. In some cases, it may not be even possible to detect these experimentally.
- (ii) The reactions in which only small amounts of products are formed and most of the reactants remain unchanged at equilibrium stage.
- (iii) The reactions in which the concentrations of the reactants and products are comparable, when the system is in equilibrium.

The extent of a reaction in equilibrium varies with the experimental conditions such as concentrations of reactants, temperature, etc. Optimisation of the operational conditions is very important in industry and laboratory so that equilibrium is favorable in the direction of the desired product. Some important aspects of equilibrium involving physical and chemical processes are dealt in this unit along with the equilibrium involving ions in aqueous solutions which is called as **ionic equilibrium**.

7.1 EQUILIBRIUM IN PHYSICAL PROCESSES

The characteristics of system at equilibrium are better understood if we examine some physical processes. The most familiar examples are **phase transformation processes**, e.g.,



7.1.1 Solid-Liquid Equilibrium

Ice and water kept in a perfectly insulated thermos flask (no exchange of heat between its contents and the surroundings) at 273K

and the atmospheric pressure are in equilibrium state and the system shows interesting characteristic features. We observe that the mass of ice and water do not change with time and the temperature remains constant. However, the equilibrium is not static. The intense activity can be noticed at the boundary between ice and water. Molecules from the liquid water collide against ice and adhere to it and some molecules of ice escape into liquid phase. There is no change of mass of ice and water, as the rates of transfer of molecules from ice into water and of reverse transfer from water into ice are equal at atmospheric pressure and 273 K.

It is obvious that ice and water are in equilibrium only at particular temperature and pressure. For any pure substance at atmospheric pressure the temperature at which the solid and liquid phases are at equilibrium is called the **normal melting point** or **normal freezing point** of the substance. The system here is in dynamic equilibrium and we can infer the following:

- (i) Both the opposing processes occur simultaneously.
- (ii) Both the processes occur at the same rate so that the amount of ice and water remains constant.

7.1.2 Liquid-Vapour Equilibrium

This equilibrium can be better understood if we consider the example of a transparent box carrying a U-tube with mercury (manometer). Drying agent like anhydrous calcium chloride (or phosphorus penta-oxide) is placed for a few hours in the box. After removing the drying agent by tilting the box on one side, a watch glass (or petri dish) containing water is quickly placed inside the box. It will be observed that the mercury level in the right limb of the manometer slowly increases and finally attains a constant value, that is, the pressure inside the box increases and reaches a constant value. Also the volume of water in the watch glass decreases (Fig. 7.1). Initially there was no water vapour (or very less) inside the box. As water evaporated the pressure in the box increased due to addition of water

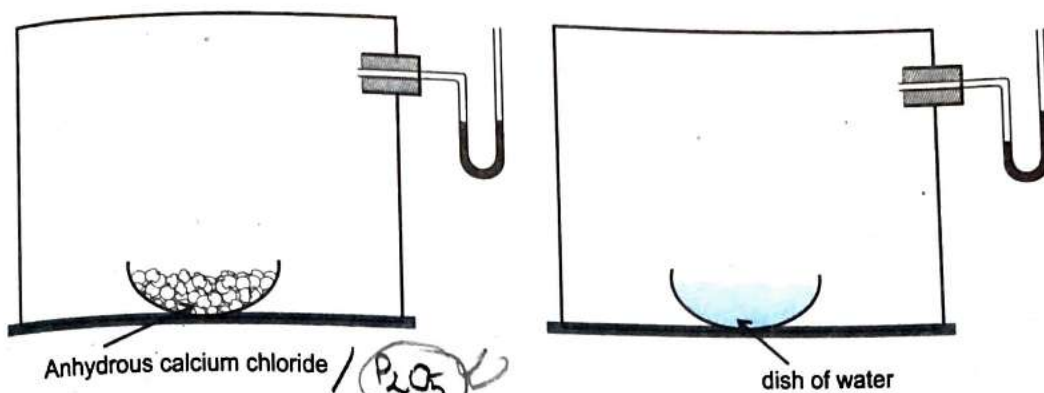
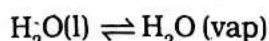


Fig.7.1 Measuring equilibrium vapour pressure of water at a constant temperature

molecules into the gaseous phase inside the box. The rate of evaporation is constant. However, the rate of increase in pressure decreases with time due to condensation of vapour into water. Finally it leads to an equilibrium condition when there is no net evaporation. This implies that the number of water molecules from the gaseous state into the liquid state also increases till the equilibrium is attained i.e.,

rate of evaporation = rate of condensation



At equilibrium the pressure exerted by the water molecules at a given temperature remains constant and is called the equilibrium vapour pressure of water (or just vapour pressure of water); vapour pressure of water increases with temperature. If the above experiment is repeated with methyl alcohol, acetone and ether, it is observed that different liquids have different equilibrium vapour pressures at the same temperature, and the liquid which has a higher vapour pressure is more volatile and has a lower boiling point.

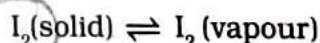
If we expose three watch glasses containing separately 1 mL each of acetone, ethyl alcohol, and water to atmosphere and repeat the experiment with different volumes of the liquids in a warmer room, it is observed that in all such cases the liquid eventually disappears and the time taken for complete evaporation depends on (i) the nature of the liquid, (ii) the amount of the liquid and (iii) the temperature. When the watch glass is open to the atmosphere, the rate of evaporation remains constant but the molecules are

dispersed into large volume of the room. As a consequence the rate of condensation from vapour to liquid state is much less than the rate of evaporation. These are open systems and it is not possible to reach equilibrium in an open system.

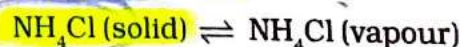
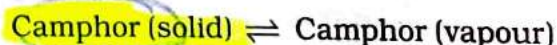
Water and water vapour are in equilibrium position at atmospheric pressure (1.013 bar) and at 100°C in a closed vessel. The boiling point of water is 100°C at 1.013 bar pressure. For any pure liquid at one atmospheric pressure (1.013 bar), the temperature at which the liquid and vapours are at equilibrium is called normal boiling point of the liquid. Boiling point of the liquid depends on the atmospheric pressure. It depends on the altitude of the place; at high altitude the boiling point decreases.

7.1.3 Solid - Vapour Equilibrium

Let us now consider the systems where solids sublime to vapour phase. If we place solid iodine in a closed vessel, after sometime the vessel gets filled up with violet vapour and the intensity of colour increases with time. After certain time the intensity of colour becomes constant and at this stage equilibrium is attained. Hence solid iodine sublimes to give iodine vapour and the iodine vapour condenses to give solid iodine. The equilibrium can be represented as,



Other examples showing this kind of equilibrium are,



Henry's law
m.p

7.1.4 Equilibrium Involving Dissolution of Solid or Gases in Liquids

Solids in liquids

We know from our experience that we can dissolve only a limited amount of salt or sugar in a given amount of water at room temperature. If we make a thick sugar syrup solution by dissolving sugar at a higher temperature, sugar crystals separate out if we cool the syrup to the room temperature. We call it a saturated solution when no more of solute can be dissolved in it at a given temperature. The concentration of the solute in a saturated solution depends upon the temperature. In a saturated solution, a dynamic equilibrium exists between the solute molecules in the solid state and in the solution:

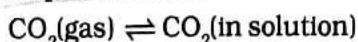
Sugar (solution) $\rightleftharpoons$ Sugar (solid), and

the rate of dissolution of sugar = rate of crystallisation of sugar.

Equality of the two rates and dynamic nature of equilibrium has been confirmed with the help of radioactive sugar. If we drop some radioactive sugar into saturated solution of non-radioactive sugar, then after some time radioactivity is observed both in the solution and in the solid sugar. Initially there were no radioactive sugar molecules in the solution but due to dynamic nature of equilibrium, there is exchange between the radioactive and non-radioactive sugar molecules between the two phases. The ratio of the radioactive to non-radioactive molecules in the solution increases till it attains a constant value.

Gases in liquids

When a soda water bottle is opened, some of the carbon dioxide gas dissolved in it fizzes out rapidly. The phenomenon arises due to difference in solubility of carbon dioxide at different pressures. There is equilibrium between the molecules in the gaseous state and the molecules dissolved in the liquid under pressure i.e.,



This equilibrium is governed by Henry's law, which states that the mass of a gas dissolved in a given mass of a solvent at any temperature is proportional to the

pressure of the gas above the solvent. This amount decreases with increase of temperature. The soda water bottle is sealed under pressure of gas when its solubility in water is high. As soon as the bottle is opened, some of the dissolved carbon dioxide gas escapes to reach a new equilibrium condition required for the lower pressure, namely its partial pressure in the atmosphere. This is how the soda water in bottle when left open to the air for some time, turns 'flat'. It can be generalised that:

- For solid $\rightleftharpoons$ liquid equilibrium, there is only one temperature (melting point) at 1 atm (1.013 bar) at which the two phases can coexist. If there is no exchange of heat with the surroundings, the mass of the two phases remains constant.
- For liquid $\rightleftharpoons$ vapour equilibrium, the vapour pressure is constant at a given temperature.
- For dissolution of solids in liquids, the solubility is constant at a given temperature.
- For dissolution of gases in liquids, the concentration of a gas in liquid is proportional to the pressure (concentration) of the gas over the liquid. These observations are summarised in Table 7.1

Table 7.1 Some Features of Physical Equilibria

Process	Conclusion
Liquid $\rightleftharpoons$ Vapour $\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{g})$	$P_{\text{H}_2\text{O}}$ constant at given temperature
Solid $\rightleftharpoons$ Liquid $\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{s}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{l})$	Melting point is fixed at constant pressure
Solute(s) $\rightleftharpoons$ Solute (solution) Sugar(s) $\rightleftharpoons$ Sugar (solution)	Concentration of solute in solution is constant at a given temperature
Gas(g) $\rightleftharpoons$ Gas (aq) $\text{CO}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons \text{CO}_2(\text{aq})$	$[\text{gas}(\text{aq})]/[\text{gas}(\text{g})]$ is constant at a given temperature $[\text{CO}_2(\text{aq})]/[\text{CO}_2(\text{g})]$ is constant at a given temperature

7.1.5 General Characteristics of Equilibria Involving Physical Processes

For the physical processes discussed above, following characteristics are common to the system at equilibrium:

- (i) Equilibrium is possible only in a closed system at a given temperature.
- (ii) Both the opposing processes occur at the same rate and there is a dynamic but stable condition.
- (iii) All measurable properties of the system remain constant.
- (iv) When equilibrium is attained for a physical process, it is characterised by constant value of one of its parameters at a given temperature. Table 7.1 lists such quantities.
- (v) The magnitude of such quantities at any stage indicates the extent to which the physical process has proceeded before reaching equilibrium.

7.2 EQUILIBRIUM IN CHEMICAL PROCESSES - DYNAMIC EQUILIBRIUM

Analogous to the physical systems, chemical reactions also attain a state of equilibrium. These reactions can occur both in forward and backward directions. When the rates of the forward and reverse reactions become equal, the concentrations of the reactants and the products remain constant. This is the stage of chemical equilibrium. This equilibrium is dynamic in nature as it consists of a forward reaction in which the reactants give product(s) and reverse reaction in which product(s) gives the original reactants.

For a better comprehension, let us consider a general case of a reversible reaction,



With passage of time, there is accumulation of the products C and D and depletion of the reactants A and B (Fig. 7.2). This leads to a decrease in the rate of forward reaction and an increase in the rate of the reverse reaction.

Eventually, the two reactions occur at the

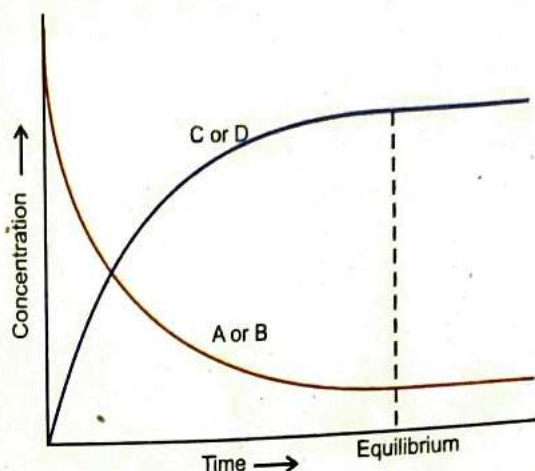


Fig. 7.2 Attainment of chemical equilibrium.

same rate and the system reaches a state of equilibrium.

Similarly, the reaction can reach the state of equilibrium even if we start with only C and D; that is, no A and B being present initially, as the equilibrium can be reached from either direction.

The dynamic nature of chemical equilibrium can be demonstrated in the synthesis of ammonia by Haber's process. In a series of experiments, Haber started with known amounts of dinitrogen and dihydrogen maintained at high temperature and pressure and at regular intervals determined the amount of ammonia present. He was successful in determining also the concentration of unreacted dihydrogen and dinitrogen. Fig. 7.4 (page 191) shows that after a certain time the composition of the mixture remains the same even though some of the reactants are still present. This constancy in composition indicates that the reaction has reached equilibrium. In order to understand the dynamic nature of the reaction, synthesis of ammonia is carried out with exactly the same starting conditions (of partial pressure and temperature) but using D_2 (deuterium) in place of H_2 . The reaction mixtures starting either with H_2 or D_2 reach equilibrium with the same composition, except that D_2 and ND_3 are present instead of H_2 and NH_3 . After equilibrium is attained, these two mixtures

Dynamic Equilibrium - A Student's Activity

Equilibrium whether in a physical or in a chemical system, is always of dynamic nature. This can be demonstrated by the use of radioactive isotopes. This is not feasible in a school laboratory. However this concept can be easily comprehended by performing the following activity. The activity can be performed in a group of 5 or 6 students.

Take two 100mL measuring cylinders (marked as 1 and 2) and two glass tubes each of 30 cm length. Diameter of the tubes may be same or different in the range of 3-5mm. Fill nearly half of the measuring cylinder-1 with coloured water (for this purpose add a crystal of potassium permanganate to water) and keep second cylinder (number 2) empty.

Put one tube in cylinder 1 and second in cylinder 2. Immerse one tube in cylinder 1, close its upper tip with a finger and transfer the coloured water contained in its lower portion to cylinder 2. Using second tube, kept in 2nd cylinder, transfer the coloured water in a similar manner from cylinder 2 to cylinder 1. In this way keep on transferring coloured water using the two glass tubes from cylinder 1 to 2 and from 2 to 1 till you notice that the level of coloured water in both the cylinders becomes constant.

If you continue intertransferring coloured solution between the cylinders, there will not be any further change in the levels of coloured water in two cylinders. If we take analogy of 'level' of coloured water with 'concentration' of reactants and products in the two cylinders, we can say the process of transfer, which continues even after the constancy of level, is indicative of dynamic nature of the process. If we repeat the experiment taking two tubes of different diameters we find that at equilibrium the level of coloured water in two cylinders is different. How far diameters are responsible for change in levels in two cylinders? Empty cylinder (2) is an indicator of no product in it at the beginning.

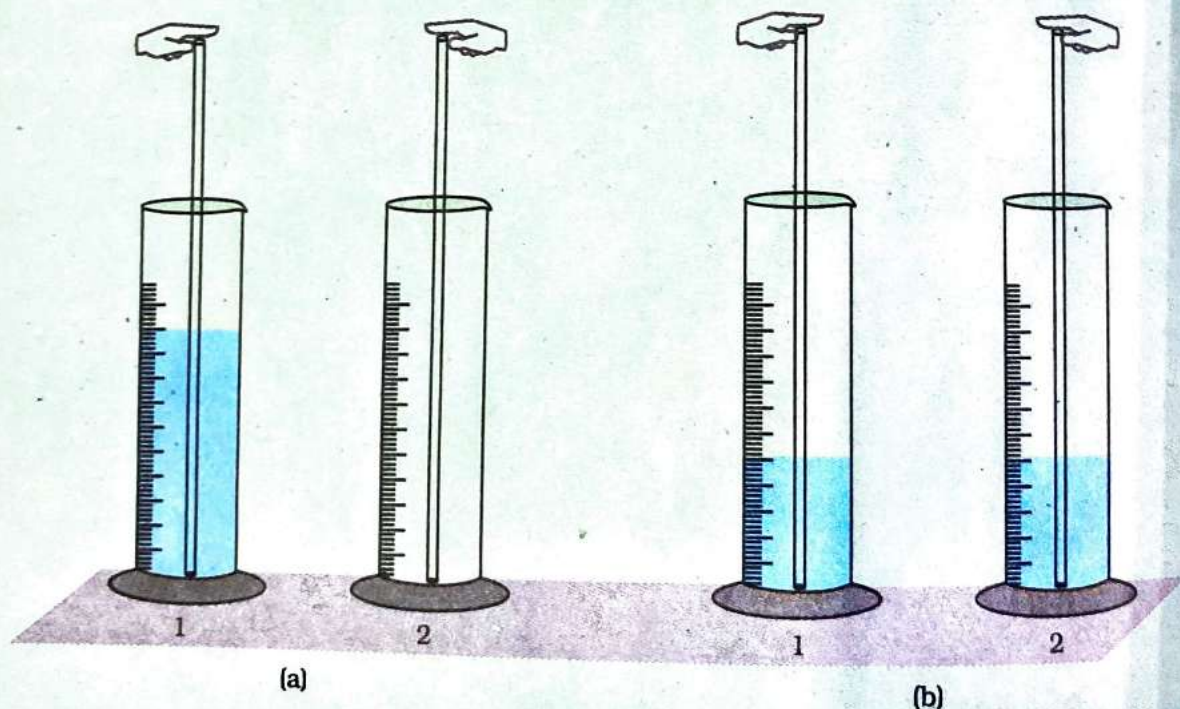


Fig.7.3 Demonstrating dynamic nature of equilibrium. (a) initial stage (b) final stage after the equilibrium is attained.

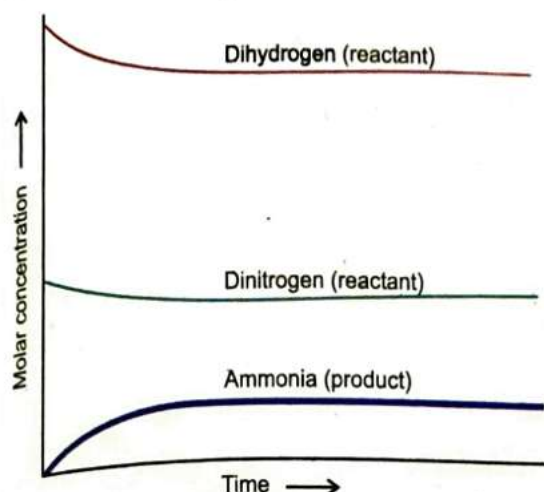
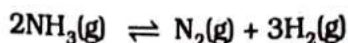
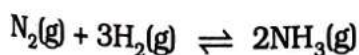


Fig 7.4 Depiction of equilibrium for the reaction
 $\text{N}_2(\text{g}) + 3\text{H}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NH}_3(\text{g})$

(H_2 , N_2 , NH_3 and D_2 , N_2 , ND_3) are mixed together and left for a while. Later, when this mixture is analysed, it is found that the concentration of ammonia is just the same as before. However, when this mixture is analysed by a mass spectrometer, it is found that ammonia and all deuterium containing forms of ammonia (NH_3 , NH_2D , NHD_2 and ND_3) and dihydrogen and its deuterated forms (H_2 , HD and D_2) are present. Thus one can conclude that scrambling of H and D atoms in the molecules must result from a continuation of the forward and reverse reactions in the mixture. If the reaction had simply stopped when they reached equilibrium, then there would have been no mixing of isotopes in this way.

Use of isotope (deuterium) in the formation of ammonia clearly indicates that **chemical reactions reach a state of dynamic equilibrium in which the rates of forward and reverse reactions are equal and there is no net change in composition.**

Equilibrium can be attained from both sides, whether we start reaction by taking, $\text{H}_2(\text{g})$ and $\text{N}_2(\text{g})$ and get $\text{NH}_3(\text{g})$ or by taking $\text{NH}_3(\text{g})$ and decomposing it into $\text{N}_2(\text{g})$ and $\text{H}_2(\text{g})$.



Similarly let us consider the reaction, $\text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{I}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{HI}(\text{g})$. If we start with equal initial concentration of H_2 and I_2 , the reaction proceeds in the forward direction and the concentration of H_2 and I_2 decreases while that of HI increases, until all of these become constant at equilibrium (Fig. 7.5). We can also start with HI alone and make the reaction to proceed in the reverse direction; the concentration of HI will decrease and concentration of H_2 and I_2 will increase until they all become constant when equilibrium is reached (Fig. 7.5). If total number of H and I atoms are same in a given volume, the same equilibrium mixture is obtained whether we start it from pure reactants or pure product.

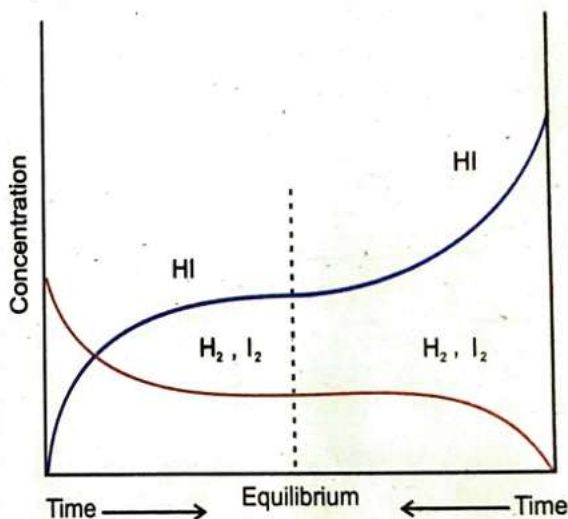


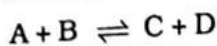
Fig. 7.5 Chemical equilibrium in the reaction $\text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{I}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{HI}(\text{g})$ can be attained from either direction

7.3 LAW OF CHEMICAL EQUILIBRIUM AND EQUILIBRIUM CONSTANT

A mixture of reactants and products in the equilibrium state is called an equilibrium mixture. In this section we shall address a number of important questions about the composition of equilibrium mixtures: What is the relationship between the concentrations of reactants and products in an equilibrium mixture? How can we determine equilibrium concentrations from initial concentrations?

What factors can be exploited to alter the composition of an equilibrium mixture? The last question in particular is important when choosing conditions for synthesis of industrial chemicals such as H_2 , NH_3 , CaO etc.

To answer these questions, let us consider a general reversible reaction:

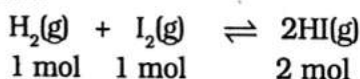


where A and B are the reactants, C and D are the products in the balanced chemical equation. On the basis of experimental studies of many reversible reactions, the Norwegian chemists Cato Maximillian Guldberg and Peter Waage proposed in 1864 that the concentrations in an equilibrium mixture are related by the following **equilibrium equation**,

$$K_c = \frac{[C][D]}{[A][B]} \quad (7.1)$$

where K_c is the equilibrium constant and the expression on the right side is called the equilibrium constant expression.

The equilibrium equation is also known as the law of mass action because in the early days of chemistry, concentration was called "active mass". In order to appreciate their work better, let us consider reaction between gaseous H_2 and I_2 carried out in a sealed vessel at 731K.



Six sets of experiments with varying initial conditions were performed, starting with only gaseous H_2 and I_2 in a sealed reaction vessel in first four experiments (1, 2, 3 and 4) and only HI in other two experiments (5 and 6). Experiment 1, 2, 3 and 4 were performed taking different concentrations of H_2 and / or I_2 , and with time it was observed that intensity of the purple colour remained constant and equilibrium was attained. Similarly, for experiments 5 and 6, the equilibrium was attained from the opposite direction.

Data obtained from all six sets of experiments are given in Table 7.2.

It is evident from the experiments 1, 2, 3 and 4 that number of moles of dihydrogen reacted = number of moles of iodine reacted = $\frac{1}{2}$ (number of moles of HI formed). Also, experiments 5 and 6 indicate that,

$$[H_2(g)]_{eq} = [I_2(g)]_{eq}$$

Knowing the above facts, in order to establish a relationship between concentrations of the reactants and products, several combinations can be tried. Let us consider the simple expression,

$$[HI(g)]_{eq} / [H_2(g)]_{eq} [I_2(g)]_{eq}$$

It can be seen from Table 7.3 that if we put the equilibrium concentrations of the reactants and products, the above expression

Table 7.2 Initial and Equilibrium Concentrations of H_2 , I_2 and HI

Experiment number	Initial concentration/mol L ⁻¹			Equilibrium concentration/mol L ⁻¹		
	[H ₂ (g)]	[I ₂ (g)]	[HI(g)]	[H ₂ (g)]	[I ₂ (g)]	[HI(g)]
1	2.4×10^{-2}	1.38×10^{-2}	0	1.14×10^{-2}	0.12×10^{-2}	2.52×10^{-2}
2	2.4×10^{-2}	1.68×10^{-2}	0	0.92×10^{-2}	0.20×10^{-2}	2.96×10^{-2}
3	2.44×10^{-2}	1.98×10^{-2}	0	0.77×10^{-2}	0.31×10^{-2}	3.34×10^{-2}
4	2.46×10^{-2}	1.76×10^{-2}	0	0.92×10^{-2}	0.22×10^{-2}	3.08×10^{-2}
5	0	0	3.04×10^{-2}	0.345×10^{-2}	0.345×10^{-2}	2.35×10^{-2}
6	0	0	7.58×10^{-2}	0.86×10^{-2}	0.86×10^{-2}	5.86×10^{-2}

Table 7.3 Expression Involving the Equilibrium Concentration of Reactants



Experiments Number	$\frac{[\text{HI}(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}}{[\text{H}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}} [\text{I}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}}$	$\frac{[\text{HI}(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}^2}{[\text{H}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}} [\text{I}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}}$
1	1840	46.4
2	1610	47.6
3	1400	46.7
4	1520	46.9
5	1970	46.4
6	790	46.4

is far from constant. However, if we consider the expression,

$$[\text{HI}(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}^2 / [\text{H}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}} [\text{I}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}$$

we find that this expression gives constant value (as shown in Table 7.3) in all the six cases. It can be seen that in this expression the power of the concentration for reactants and products are actually the stoichiometric coefficients in the equation for the chemical reaction. Thus, for the reaction $\text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{I}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{HI}(\text{g})$, following equation 7.1, the equilibrium constant K_c is written as,

$$K_c = [\text{HI}(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}}^2 / [\text{H}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}} [\text{I}_2(\text{g})]_{\text{eq}} \quad (7.2)$$

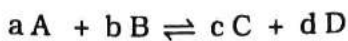
Generally the subscript 'eq' (used for equilibrium) is omitted from the concentration terms. It is taken for granted that the concentrations in the expression for K_c are equilibrium values. We, therefore, write,

$$K_c = [\text{HI}(\text{g})]^2 / [\text{H}_2(\text{g})] [\text{I}_2(\text{g})] \quad (7.3)$$

The subscript 'c' indicates that K_c is expressed in concentrations of mol L^{-1} .

At a given temperature, the product of concentrations of the reaction products raised to the respective stoichiometric coefficient in the balanced chemical equation divided by the product of concentrations of the reactants raised to their individual stoichiometric coefficients has a constant value. This is known as the Equilibrium Law or Law of Chemical Equilibrium.

The equilibrium constant for a general reaction,

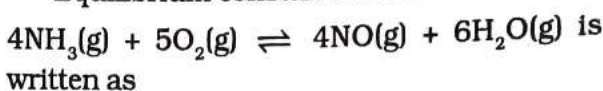


is expressed as,

$$K_c = [\text{C}]^c [\text{D}]^d / [\text{A}]^a [\text{B}]^b \quad (7.4)$$

where [A], [B], [C] and [D] are the equilibrium concentrations of the reactants and products.

Equilibrium constant for the reaction,



$$K_c = [\text{NO}]^4 [\text{H}_2\text{O}]^6 / [\text{NH}_3]^4 [\text{O}_2]^5$$

Molar concentration of different species is indicated by enclosing these in square bracket and, as mentioned above, it is implied that these are equilibrium concentrations. While writing expression for equilibrium constant, symbol for phases (s, l, g) are generally ignored.

Let us write equilibrium constant for the reaction, $\text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{I}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{HI}(\text{g})$ (7.5)

$$\text{as, } K_c = [\text{HI}]^2 / [\text{H}_2] [\text{I}_2] = x \quad (7.6)$$

The equilibrium constant for the reverse reaction, $2\text{HI}(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons \text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{I}_2(\text{g})$, at the same temperature is,

$$K'_c = [\text{H}_2] [\text{I}_2] / [\text{HI}]^2 = 1/x = 1/K_c \quad (7.7)$$

$$\text{Thus, } K'_c = 1/K_c \quad (7.8)$$

Equilibrium constant for the reverse reaction is the inverse of the equilibrium constant for the reaction in the forward direction.

If we change the stoichiometric coefficients in a chemical equation by multiplying throughout by a factor then we must make sure that the expression for equilibrium constant also reflects that change. For example, if the reaction (7.5) is written as,



the equilibrium constant for the above reaction is given by

$$\begin{aligned} K''_c &= [\text{HI}] / [\text{H}_2]^{1/2} [\text{I}_2]^{1/2} = ([\text{HI}]^2 / [\text{H}_2] [\text{I}_2])^{1/2} \\ &= x^{1/2} = K_c^{1/2} \end{aligned} \quad (7.10)$$

On multiplying the equation (7.5) by n, we get



Therefore, equilibrium constant for the reaction is equal to K_c^n . These findings are summarised in Table 7.4. It should be noted that because the equilibrium constants K_c and K'_c have different numerical values, it is important to specify the form of the balanced chemical equation when quoting the value of an equilibrium constant.

Table 7.4 Relations between Equilibrium Constants for a General Reaction and its Multiples.

Chemical equation	Equilibrium constant
$a\text{A} + b\text{B} \rightleftharpoons c\text{C} + d\text{D}$	K_c
$c\text{C} + d\text{D} \rightleftharpoons a\text{A} + b\text{B}$	$K'_c = (1/K_c)$
$na\text{A} + nb\text{B} \rightleftharpoons nc\text{C} + nd\text{D}$	$K''_c = (K_c^n)$

Problem 7.1

The following concentrations were obtained for the formation of NH_3 from N_2 and H_2 at equilibrium at 500K. $[\text{N}_2] = 1.5 \times 10^{-2}\text{M}$, $[\text{H}_2] = 3.0 \times 10^{-2}\text{M}$ and $[\text{NH}_3] = 1.2 \times 10^{-2}\text{M}$. Calculate equilibrium constant.

Solution

The equilibrium constant for the reaction, $\text{N}_2(\text{g}) + 3\text{H}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NH}_3(\text{g})$ can be written as,

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{NH}_3(\text{g})]^2}{[\text{N}_2(\text{g})][\text{H}_2(\text{g})]^3}$$

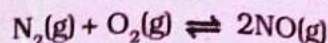
$$= \frac{(1.2 \times 10^{-2})^2}{(1.5 \times 10^{-2})(3.0 \times 10^{-2})^3}$$

$$= 0.106 \times 10^4 = 1.06 \times 10^3$$

Problem 7.2

At equilibrium, the concentrations of $\text{N}_2 = 3.0 \times 10^{-3}\text{M}$, $\text{O}_2 = 4.2 \times 10^{-3}\text{M}$ and $\text{NO} = 2.8 \times 10^{-3}\text{M}$ in a sealed vessel at

800K. What will be K_c for the reaction



Solution

For the reaction equilibrium constant, K_c can be written as,

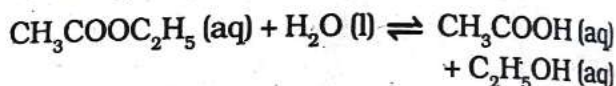
$$K_c = \frac{[\text{NO}]^2}{[\text{N}_2][\text{O}_2]}$$

$$= \frac{(2.8 \times 10^{-3}\text{M})^2}{(3.0 \times 10^{-3}\text{M})(4.2 \times 10^{-3}\text{M})}$$

$$= 0.622$$

7.4 HOMOGENEOUS EQUILIBRIA

In a homogeneous system, all the reactants and products are in the same phase. For example, in the gaseous reaction, $\text{N}_2(\text{g}) + 3\text{H}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NH}_3(\text{g})$, reactants and products are in the homogeneous phase. Similarly, for the reactions,



all the reactants and products are in homogeneous solution phase. We shall now consider equilibrium constant for some homogeneous reactions.

7.4.1 Equilibrium Constant in Gaseous Systems

So far we have expressed equilibrium constant of the reactions in terms of molar concentration of the reactants and products, and used symbol, K_c for it. For reactions involving gases, however, it is usually more convenient to express the equilibrium constant in terms of partial pressure.

The ideal gas equation is written as,

$$pV = nRT$$

$$\Rightarrow p = \frac{n}{V}RT$$

Here, p is the pressure in Pa, n is the number of moles of the gas, V is the volume in m^3 and

T is the temperature in Kelvin

Therefore,

n/V is concentration expressed in mol/m^3

If concentration c , is in mol/L or mol/dm^3 , and p is in bar then

$$p = cRT,$$

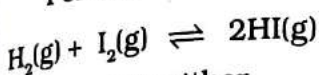
We can also write $p = [\text{gas}]RT$.

Here, $R = 0.0831 \text{ bar litre/mol K}$

At constant temperature, the pressure of the gas is proportional to its concentration i.e.,

$$p \propto [\text{gas}]$$

For reaction in equilibrium



We can write either

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{HI}(\text{g})]^2}{[\text{H}_2(\text{g})][\text{I}_2(\text{g})]}$$

$$\text{or } K_p = \frac{(p_{\text{HI}})^2}{(p_{\text{H}_2})(p_{\text{I}_2})} \quad (7.12)$$

Further, since $p_{\text{HI}} = [\text{HI}(\text{g})]RT$

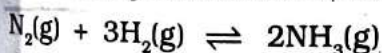
$$p_{\text{I}_2} = [\text{I}_2(\text{g})]RT$$

$$p_{\text{H}_2} = [\text{H}_2(\text{g})]RT$$

Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} K_p &= \frac{(p_{\text{HI}})^2}{(p_{\text{H}_2})(p_{\text{I}_2})} = \frac{[\text{HI}(\text{g})]^2 [RT]^2}{[\text{H}_2(\text{g})]RT \cdot [\text{I}_2(\text{g})]RT} \\ &= \frac{[\text{HI}(\text{g})]^2}{[\text{H}_2(\text{g})][\text{I}_2(\text{g})]} = K_c \end{aligned} \quad (7.13)$$

In this example, $K_p = K_c$ i.e., both equilibrium constants are equal. However, this is not always the case. For example in reaction

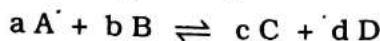


$$\begin{aligned} K_p &= \frac{(p_{\text{NH}_3})^2}{(p_{\text{N}_2})(p_{\text{H}_2})^3} \\ &= \frac{[\text{NH}_3(\text{g})]^2 [RT]^2}{[\text{N}_2(\text{g})]RT \cdot [\text{H}_2(\text{g})]^3 (RT)^3} \end{aligned}$$

$$= \frac{[\text{NH}_3(\text{g})]^2 [RT]^{-2}}{[\text{N}_2(\text{g})][\text{H}_2(\text{g})]^3} = K_c (RT)^{-2}$$

$$\text{or } K_p = K_c (RT)^{-2} \quad (7.14)$$

Similarly, for a general reaction



$$\begin{aligned} K_p &= \frac{(p_c^c)(p_d^d)}{(p_a^a)(p_b^b)} = \frac{[\text{C}]^c [\text{D}]^d (RT)^{(c+d)}}{[\text{A}]^a [\text{B}]^b (RT)^{(a+b)}} \\ &= \frac{[\text{C}]^c [\text{D}]^d}{[\text{A}]^a [\text{B}]^b} (RT)^{(c+d)-(a+b)} \\ &= \frac{[\text{C}]^c [\text{D}]^d}{[\text{A}]^a [\text{B}]^b} (RT)^{\Delta n} = \boxed{K_c (RT)^{\Delta n}} \end{aligned} \quad (7.15)$$

where $\Delta n = (\text{number of moles of gaseous products}) - (\text{number of moles of gaseous reactants})$ in the balanced chemical equation.

It is necessary that while calculating the value of K_p , pressure should be expressed in bar because standard state for pressure is 1 bar. We know from Unit 1 that:

$$1 \text{ pascal, Pa} = 1 \text{ Nm}^{-2}, \text{ and } 1 \text{ bar} = 10^5 \text{ Pa}$$

K_p values for a few selected reactions at different temperatures are given in Table 7.5

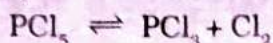
Table 7.5 Equilibrium Constants, K_p for a Few Selected Reactions

Reaction	Temperature/K	K_p
$\text{N}_2(\text{g}) + 3\text{H}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NH}_3$	298	6.8×10^5
	400	41
	500	3.6×10^{-2}
$2\text{SO}_2(\text{g}) + \text{O}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{SO}_3(\text{g})$	298	4.0×10^{24}
	500	2.5×10^{10}
	700	3.0×10^4
$\text{N}_2\text{O}_4(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NO}_2(\text{g})$	298	0.98
	400	47.9
	500	1700

Problem 7.3

PCl_5 , PCl_3 and Cl_2 are at equilibrium at 500 K and having concentration 1.59M PCl_3 , 1.59M Cl_2 and 1.41 M PCl_5 .

Calculate K_c for the reaction,



Solution

The equilibrium constant K_c for the above reaction can be written as,

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{PCl}_3][\text{Cl}_2]}{[\text{PCl}_5]} = \frac{(1.59)^2}{(1.41)} = 1.79$$

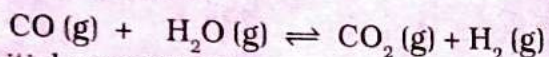
Problem 7.4

The value of $K_c = 4.24$ at 800K for the reaction,
 $\text{CO (g)} + \text{H}_2\text{O (g)} \rightleftharpoons \text{CO}_2\text{ (g)} + \text{H}_2\text{ (g)}$

Calculate equilibrium concentrations of CO_2 , H_2 , CO and H_2O at 800 K, if only CO and H_2O are present initially at concentrations of 0.10M each.

Solution

For the reaction,



Initial concentration:

$$0.1\text{M} \quad 0.1\text{M} \quad 0 \quad 0$$

Let x mole per litre of each of the product be formed.

At equilibrium:

$$(0.1-x)\text{M} \quad (0.1-x)\text{M} \quad x\text{M} \quad x\text{M}$$

where x is the amount of CO_2 and H_2 at equilibrium.

Hence, equilibrium constant can be written as,

$$K_c = x^2 / (0.1-x)^2 = 4.24$$

$$x^2 = 4.24(0.01 + x^2 - 0.2x)$$

$$x^2 = 0.0424 + 4.24x^2 - 0.848x$$

$$3.24x^2 - 0.848x + 0.0424 = 0$$

$$a = 3.24, b = -0.848, c = 0.0424$$

(for quadratic equation $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$,

$$x = \frac{(-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac})}{2a}$$

$$x = \frac{0.848 \pm \sqrt{(0.848)^2 - 4(3.24)(0.0424)}}{2(3.24)}$$

$$x = (0.848 \pm 0.4118) / 6.48$$

$$x_1 = (0.848 - 0.4118) / 6.48 = 0.067$$

$$x_2 = (0.848 + 0.4118) / 6.48 = 0.194$$

the value 0.194 should be neglected because it will give concentration of the reactant which is more than initial concentration.

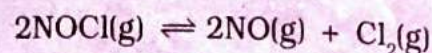
Hence the equilibrium concentrations are,

$$[\text{CO}_2] = [\text{H}_2] = x = 0.067\text{M}$$

$$[\text{CO}] = [\text{H}_2\text{O}] = 0.1 - 0.067 = 0.033\text{M}$$

Problem 7.5

For the equilibrium,



the value of the equilibrium constant, K_c is 3.75×10^{-6} at 1069 K. Calculate the K_p for the reaction at this temperature?

Solution

We know that,

$$K_p = K_c(RT)^{\Delta n}$$

For the above reaction,

$$\Delta n = (2+1) - 2 = 1$$

$$K_p = 3.75 \times 10^{-6} (0.0831 \times 1069)$$

$$K_p = 0.033$$

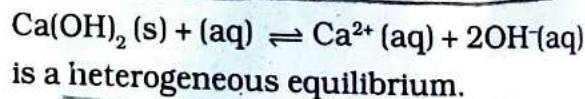
7.5 HETEROGENEOUS EQUILIBRIA

Equilibrium in a system having more than one phase is called heterogeneous equilibrium.

The equilibrium between water vapour and liquid water in a closed container is an example of heterogeneous equilibrium.

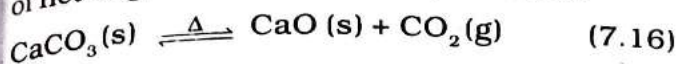


In this example, there is a gas phase and a liquid phase. In the same way, equilibrium between a solid and its saturated solution,



Heterogeneous equilibria often involve pure solids or liquids. We can simplify equilibrium expressions for the heterogeneous equilibria involving a pure liquid or a pure solid, as the molar concentration of a pure solid or liquid is constant (i.e., independent of the amount present). In other words if a substance 'X' is involved, then $[X(s)]$ and $[X(l)]$ are constant, whatever the amount of 'X' is taken. Contrary

to this, $[X(g)]$ and $[X(aq)]$ will vary as the amount of X in a given volume varies. Let us take thermal dissociation of calcium carbonate which is an interesting and important example of heterogeneous chemical equilibrium.



On the basis of the stoichiometric equation, we can write,

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{CaO}(s)][\text{CO}_2(g)]}{[\text{CaCO}_3(s)]}$$

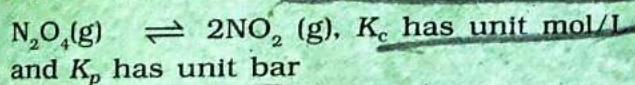
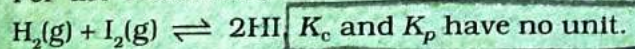
Since $[\text{CaCO}_3(s)]$ and $[\text{CaO}(s)]$ are both constant, therefore modified equilibrium constant for the thermal decomposition of calcium carbonate will be

$$K'_c = [\text{CO}_2(g)] \quad (7.17)$$

$$\text{or } K_p = P_{\text{CO}_2} \quad (7.18)$$

Units of Equilibrium Constant

The value of equilibrium constant K_c can be calculated by substituting the concentration terms in mol/L and for K_p partial pressure is substituted in Pa, kPa, bar or atm. This results in units of equilibrium constant based on molarity or pressure, unless the exponents of both the numerator and denominator are same. For the reactions,

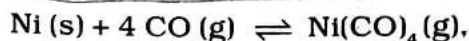


Equilibrium constants can also be expressed as dimensionless quantities if the standard state of reactants and products are specified. For a pure gas, the standard state is 1 bar. Therefore a pressure of 4 bar in standard state can be expressed as $4 \text{ bar}/1 \text{ bar} = 4$, which is a dimensionless number. Standard state (c_o) for a solute is 1 molar solution and all concentrations can be measured with respect to it. The numerical value of equilibrium constant depends on the standard state chosen. Thus, in this system both K_p and K_c are dimensionless quantities but have different numerical values due to different standard states.

This shows that at a particular temperature, there is a constant concentration or pressure of CO_2 in equilibrium with $\text{CaO}(s)$ and $\text{CaCO}_3(s)$. Experimentally it has been found that at 1100 K, the pressure of CO_2 in equilibrium with $\text{CaCO}_3(s)$ and $\text{CaO}(s)$, is $2.0 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa}$. Therefore, equilibrium constant at 1100K for the above reaction is:

$$K_p = P_{\text{CO}_2} = 2 \times 10^5 \text{ Pa} / 10^5 \text{ Pa} = 2.00$$

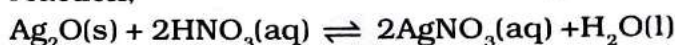
Similarly, in the equilibrium between nickel, carbon monoxide and nickel carbonyl (used in the purification of nickel),



the equilibrium constant is written as

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{Ni}(\text{CO})_4]}{[\text{CO}]^4}$$

It must be remembered that for the existence of heterogeneous equilibrium pure solids or liquids must also be present (however small the amount may be) at equilibrium, but their concentrations or partial pressures do not appear in the expression of the equilibrium constant. In the reaction,



$$K_c = \frac{[\text{AgNO}_3]^2}{[\text{HNO}_3]^2}$$

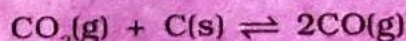
Problem 7.6

The value of K_p for the reaction, $\text{CO}_2(g) + \text{C}(s) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{CO}(g)$ is 3.0 at 1000 K. If initially $P_{\text{CO}_2} = 0.48 \text{ bar}$ and $P_{\text{CO}} = 0 \text{ bar}$ and pure graphite is present, calculate the equilibrium partial pressures of CO and CO_2 .

Solution

For the reaction,

let 'x' be the decrease in pressure of CO_2 , then



Initial

pressure: 0.48 bar

0

At equilibrium:

(0.48 - x) bar 2x bar

$$K_p = \frac{p_{\text{CO}}^2}{p_{\text{CO}_2}}$$

$$K_p = (2x)^2 / (0.48 - x) = 3$$

$$4x^2 = 3(0.48 - x)$$

$$4x^2 = 1.44 - x$$

$$4x^2 + 3x - 1.44 = 0$$

$$a = 4, b = 3, c = -1.44$$

$$x = \frac{(-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac})}{2a}$$

$$= [-3 \pm \sqrt{(3)^2 - 4(4)(-1.44)}] / 2 \times 4$$

$$= (-3 \pm 5.66) / 8$$

= (-3 + 5.66) / 8 (as value of x cannot be negative hence we neglect that value)

$$x = 2.66 / 8 = 0.33$$

The equilibrium partial pressures are,

$$p_{\text{CO}} = 2x = 2 \times 0.33 = 0.66 \text{ bar}$$

$$p_{\text{CO}_2} = 0.48 - x = 0.48 - 0.33 = 0.15 \text{ bar}$$

7.6 APPLICATIONS OF EQUILIBRIUM CONSTANTS

Before considering the applications of equilibrium constants, let us summarise the important features of equilibrium constants as follows:

1. Expression for equilibrium constant is applicable only when concentrations of the reactants and products have attained constant value at equilibrium state.
2. The value of equilibrium constant is independent of initial concentrations of the reactants and products.
3. Equilibrium constant is temperature dependent having one unique value for a particular reaction represented by a balanced equation at a given temperature.
4. The equilibrium constant for the reverse reaction is equal to the inverse of the equilibrium constant for the forward reaction.

5. The equilibrium constant K for a reaction is related to the equilibrium constant of the corresponding reaction, whose equation is obtained by multiplying or dividing the equation for the original reaction by a small integer.

Let us consider applications of equilibrium constant to:

- predict the extent of a reaction on the basis of its magnitude,
- predict the direction of the reaction, and
- calculate equilibrium concentrations.

7.6.1 Predicting the Extent of a Reaction

The numerical value of the equilibrium constant for a reaction indicates the extent of the reaction. But it is important to note that an equilibrium constant does not give any information about the rate at which the equilibrium is reached. The magnitude of K_c or K_p is directly proportional to the concentrations of products (as these appear in the numerator of equilibrium constant expression) and inversely proportional to the concentrations of the reactants (these appear in the denominator). This implies that a high value of K is suggestive of a high concentration of products and vice-versa.

We can make the following generalisations concerning the composition of equilibrium mixtures:

- If $K_c > 10^3$, products predominate over reactants, i.e., if K_c is very large, the reaction proceeds nearly to completion. Consider the following examples:
 - (a) The reaction of H_2 with O_2 at 500 K has a very large equilibrium constant, $K_c = 2.4 \times 10^{47}$.
 - (b) $\text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{Cl}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{HCl}(\text{g})$ at 300 K has $K_c = 4.0 \times 10^{31}$.
 - (c) $\text{H}_2(\text{g}) + \text{Br}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{HBr}(\text{g})$ at 300 K, $K_c = 5.4 \times 10^{18}$
- If $K_c < 10^{-3}$, reactants predominate over products, i.e., if K_c is very small, the reaction proceeds rarely. Consider the following examples:

(a) The decomposition of H_2O into H_2 and O_2 at 500 K has a very small equilibrium constant, $K_c = 4.1 \times 10^{-48}$

(b) $\text{N}_2(\text{g}) + \text{O}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NO}(\text{g})$, at 298 K has $K_c = 4.8 \times 10^{-31}$.

If K_c is in the range of 10^{-3} to 10^3 , appreciable concentrations of both reactants and products are present. Consider the following examples:

(a) For reaction of H_2 with I_2 to give HI , $K_c = 57.0$ at 700 K.

(b) Also, gas phase decomposition of N_2O_4 to NO_2 is another reaction with a value of $K_c = 4.64 \times 10^{-3}$ at 25°C which is neither too small nor too large. Hence, equilibrium mixtures contain appreciable concentrations of both N_2O_4 and NO_2 .

These generalisations are illustrated in Fig. 7.6

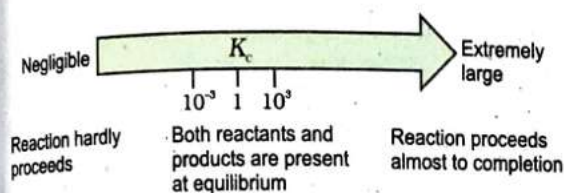


Fig. 7.6 Dependence of extent of reaction on K_c

7.6.2 Predicting the Direction of the Reaction

The equilibrium constant helps in predicting the direction in which a given reaction will proceed at any stage. For this purpose, we calculate the **reaction quotient Q** . The reaction quotient, Q (Q_c with molar concentrations and Q_p with partial pressures) is defined in the same way as the equilibrium constant K_c except that the concentrations in Q_c are not necessarily equilibrium values. For a general reaction:



$$Q_c = \frac{[\text{C}]^c [\text{D}]^d}{[\text{A}]^a [\text{B}]^b} \quad (7.20)$$

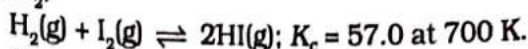
Then,

If $Q_c > K_c$, the reaction will proceed in the direction of reactants (reverse reaction).

If $Q_c < K_c$, the reaction will proceed in the direction of the products (forward reaction).

If $Q_c = K_c$, the reaction mixture is already at equilibrium.

Consider the gaseous reaction of H_2 with I_2 ,



Suppose we have molar concentrations $[\text{H}_2]_t = 0.10 \text{ M}$, $[\text{I}_2]_t = 0.20 \text{ M}$ and $[\text{HI}]_t = 0.40 \text{ M}$. (the subscript t on the concentration symbols means that the concentrations were measured at some arbitrary time t , not necessarily at equilibrium).

Thus, the reaction quotient, Q_c at this stage of the reaction is given by,

$$Q_c = \frac{[\text{HI}]_t^2}{[\text{H}_2]_t [\text{I}_2]_t} = \frac{(0.40)^2}{(0.10)(0.20)} = 8.0$$

Now, in this case, Q_c (8.0) does not equal K_c (57.0), so the mixture of $\text{H}_2(\text{g})$, $\text{I}_2(\text{g})$ and $\text{HI}(\text{g})$ is not at equilibrium; that is, more $\text{H}_2(\text{g})$ and $\text{I}_2(\text{g})$ will react to form more $\text{HI}(\text{g})$ and their concentrations will decrease till $Q_c = K_c$.

The reaction quotient, Q_c is useful in predicting the direction of reaction by comparing the values of Q_c and K_c .

Thus, we can make the following generalisations concerning the direction of the reaction (Fig. 7.7) :

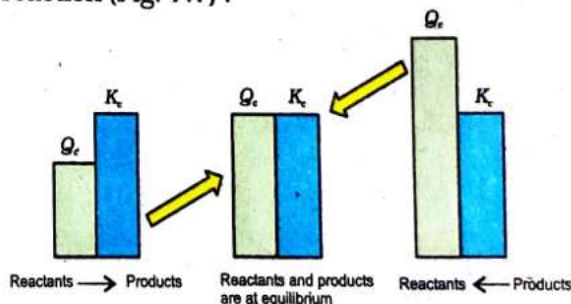


Fig. 7.7 Predicting the direction of the reaction

- If $Q_c < K_c$, net reaction goes from left to right
- If $Q_c > K_c$, net reaction goes from right to left.
- If $Q_c = K_c$, no net reaction occurs.

Problem 7.7

The value of K_c for the reaction

$2\text{A} \rightleftharpoons \text{B} + \text{C}$ is 2×10^{-3} . At a given time, the composition of reaction mixture is $[\text{A}] = [\text{B}] = [\text{C}] = 3 \times 10^{-4} \text{ M}$. In which direction the reaction will proceed?

Solution

For the reaction the reaction quotient Q_c is given by,

$$Q_c = [B][C] / [A]^2$$

$$\text{as } [A] = [B] = [C] = 3 \times 10^{-4} \text{ M}$$

$$Q_c = (3 \times 10^{-4})(3 \times 10^{-4}) / (3 \times 10^{-4})^2 = 1$$

as $Q_c > K_c$ so the reaction will proceed in the reverse direction.

7.6.3 Calculating Equilibrium Concentrations

In case of a problem in which we know the initial concentrations but do not know any of the equilibrium concentrations, the following three steps shall be followed:

Step 1. Write the balanced equation for the reaction.

Step 2. Under the balanced equation, make a table that lists for each substance involved in the reaction:

- the initial concentration,
- the change in concentration on going to equilibrium, and
- the equilibrium concentration.

In constructing the table, define x as the concentration (mol/L) of one of the substances that reacts on going to equilibrium, then use the stoichiometry of the reaction to determine the concentrations of the other substances in terms of x .

Step 3. Substitute the equilibrium concentrations into the equilibrium equation for the reaction and solve for x . If you are to solve a quadratic equation choose the mathematical solution that makes chemical sense.

Step 4. Calculate the equilibrium concentrations from the calculated value of x .

Step 5. Check your results by substituting them into the equilibrium equation.

Problem 7.8

13.8g of N_2O_4 was placed in a 1L reaction vessel at 400K and allowed to attain equilibrium



The total pressure at equilibrium was found to be 9.15 bar. Calculate K_c , K_p and partial pressure at equilibrium.

Solution

We know $pV = nRT$

Total volume (V) = 1 L

Molecular mass of N_2O_4 = 92 g

Number of moles = $13.8\text{g}/92\text{g} = 0.15$ of the gas (n)

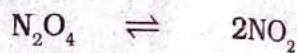
Gas constant (R) = $0.083 \text{ bar L mol}^{-1}\text{K}^{-1}$

Temperature (T) = 400 K

$$pV = nRT$$

$$p \times 1\text{L} = 0.15 \text{ mol} \times 0.083 \text{ bar L mol}^{-1}\text{K}^{-1} \times 400 \text{ K}$$

$$p = 4.98 \text{ bar}$$



Initial pressure: 4.98 bar 0

At equilibrium: $(4.98 - x)$ bar $2x$ bar

Hence,

$$p_{\text{total}} \text{ at equilibrium} = p_{\text{N}_2\text{O}_4} + p_{\text{NO}_2}$$

$$9.15 = (4.98 - x) + 2x$$

$$9.15 = 4.98 + x$$

$$x = 9.15 - 4.98 = 4.17 \text{ bar}$$

Partial pressures at equilibrium are,

$$p_{\text{N}_2\text{O}_4} = 4.98 - 4.17 = 0.81 \text{ bar}$$

$$p_{\text{NO}_2} = 2x = 2 \times 4.17 = 8.34 \text{ bar}$$

$$K_p = (p_{\text{NO}_2})^2 / p_{\text{N}_2\text{O}_4} \\ = (8.34)^2 / 0.81 = 85.87$$

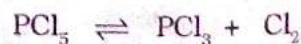
$$K_p = K_c(RT)^{\Delta n}$$

$$85.87 = K_c(0.083 \times 400)^1$$

$$K_c = 2.586 = 2.6$$

Problem 7.9

3.00 mol of PCl_5 kept in 1L closed reaction vessel was allowed to attain equilibrium at 380K. Calculate composition of the mixture at equilibrium. $K_c = 1.80$

Solution

Initial

concentration: 3.0 0 0

Let x mol per litre of PCl_5 be dissociated,
At equilibrium:



$$K_c = [\text{PCl}_3][\text{Cl}_2]/[\text{PCl}_5]$$

$$1.8 = x^2 / (3 - x)$$

$$x^2 + 1.8x - 5.4 = 0$$

$$x = [-1.8 \pm \sqrt{(1.8)^2 - 4(-5.4)}] / 2$$

$$x = [-1.8 \pm \sqrt{3.24 + 21.6}] / 2$$

$$x = [-1.8 \pm 4.98] / 2$$

$$x = [-1.8 + 4.98] / 2 = 1.59$$

$$[\text{PCl}_5] = 3.0 - x = 3 - 1.59 = 1.41 \text{ M}$$

$$[\text{PCl}_3] = [\text{Cl}_2] = x = 1.59 \text{ M}$$

7.7 RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN EQUILIBRIUM CONSTANT K , REACTION QUOTIENT Q AND GIBBS ENERGY G

The value of K_c for a reaction does not depend on the rate of the reaction. However, as you have studied in Unit 6, it is directly related to the thermodynamics of the reaction and in particular, to the change in Gibbs energy, ΔG . If,

- ΔG is negative, then the reaction is spontaneous and proceeds in the forward direction.
- ΔG is positive, then reaction is considered non-spontaneous. Instead, as reverse reaction would have a negative ΔG , the products of the forward reaction shall be converted to the reactants.
- ΔG is 0, reaction has achieved equilibrium; at this point, there is no longer any free energy left to drive the reaction.

A mathematical expression of this thermodynamic view of equilibrium can be described by the following equation:

$$\Delta G = \Delta G^\ominus + RT \ln Q \quad (7.21)$$

where, $G^\ominus$ is standard Gibbs energy.

At equilibrium, when $\Delta G = 0$ and $Q = K_c$, the equation (7.21) becomes,

$$\Delta G = \Delta G^\ominus + RT \ln K = 0 \quad (7.22)$$

$$\Delta G^\ominus = -RT \ln K$$

$$\ln K = -\Delta G^\ominus / RT$$

Taking antilog of both sides, we get,

$$K = e^{-\Delta G^\ominus / RT} \quad (7.23)$$

Hence, using the equation (7.23), the reaction spontaneity can be interpreted in terms of the value of $\Delta G^\ominus$.

- If $\Delta G^\ominus < 0$, then $-\Delta G^\ominus / RT$ is positive, and $e^{-\Delta G^\ominus / RT} > 1$, making $K > 1$, which implies a spontaneous reaction or the reaction which proceeds in the forward direction to such an extent that the products are present predominantly.
- If $\Delta G^\ominus > 0$, then $-\Delta G^\ominus / RT$ is negative, and $e^{-\Delta G^\ominus / RT} < 1$, that is, $K < 1$, which implies a non-spontaneous reaction or a reaction which proceeds in the forward direction to such a small degree that only a very minute quantity of product is formed.

Problem 7.10

The value of $\Delta G^\ominus$ for the phosphorylation of glucose in glycolysis is 13.8 kJ/mol. Find the value of K_c at 298 K.

Solution

$$\Delta G^\ominus = 13.8 \text{ kJ/mol} = 13.8 \times 10^3 \text{ J/mol}$$

$$\text{Also, } \Delta G^\ominus = -RT \ln K_c$$

$$\text{Hence, } \ln K_c = -13.8 \times 10^3 \text{ J/mol} / (8.314 \text{ J mol}^{-1} \text{ K}^{-1} \times 298 \text{ K})$$

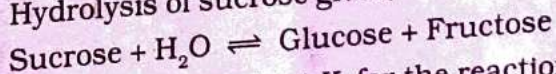
$$\ln K_c = -5.569$$

$$K_c = e^{-5.569}$$

$$K_c = 3.81 \times 10^{-3}$$

Problem 7.11

Hydrolysis of sucrose gives,



Equilibrium constant K_c for the reaction is 2×10^{13} at 300K. Calculate $\Delta G^\ominus$ at 300K.

Solution

$$\Delta G^\ominus = -RT \ln K_c$$

$$\Delta G^\ominus = -8.314 \text{ J mol}^{-1} \text{ K}^{-1} \times 300 \text{ K} \times \ln(2 \times 10^{13})$$

$$\Delta G^\ominus = -7.64 \times 10^4 \text{ J mol}^{-1}$$

7.8 FACTORS AFFECTING EQUILIBRIA

One of the principal goals of chemical synthesis is to maximise the conversion of the reactants

to products while minimizing the expenditure of energy. This implies maximum yield of products at mild temperature and pressure conditions. If it does not happen, then the experimental conditions need to be adjusted. For example, in the Haber process for the synthesis of ammonia from N_2 and H_2 , the choice of experimental conditions is of real economic importance. Annual world production of ammonia is about hundred million tones, primarily for use as fertilizers.

Equilibrium constant, K_c is independent of initial concentrations. But if a system at equilibrium is subjected to a change in the concentration of one or more of the reacting substances, then the system is no longer at equilibrium; and net reaction takes place in some direction until the system returns to equilibrium once again. Similarly, a change in temperature or pressure of the system may also alter the equilibrium. In order to decide what course the reaction adopts and make a qualitative prediction about the effect of a change in conditions on equilibrium we use **Le Chatelier's principle**. It states that a change in any of the factors that determine the equilibrium conditions of a system will cause the system to change in such a manner so as to reduce or to counteract the effect of the change. This is applicable to all physical and chemical equilibria.

We shall now be discussing factors which can influence the equilibrium.

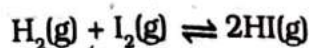
7.8.1 Effect of Concentration Change

In general, when equilibrium is disturbed by the addition/removal of any reactant/products, Le Chatelier's principle predicts that:

- The concentration stress of an added reactant/product is relieved by net reaction in the direction that consumes the added substance.
 - The concentration stress of a removed reactant/product is relieved by net reaction in the direction that replenishes the removed substance.
- or in other words,

"When the concentration of any of the reactants or products in a reaction at equilibrium is changed, the composition of the equilibrium mixture changes so as to minimize the effect of concentration changes".

Let us take the reaction,



If H_2 is added to the reaction mixture at equilibrium, then the equilibrium of the reaction is disturbed. In order to restore it, the reaction proceeds in a direction wherein H_2 is consumed, i.e., more of H_2 and I_2 react to form HI and finally the equilibrium shifts in right (forward) direction (Fig. 7.8). This is in accordance with the Le Chatelier's principle which implies that in case of addition of a reactant/product, a new equilibrium will be set up in which the concentration of the reactant/product should be less than what it was after the addition but more than what it was in the original mixture.

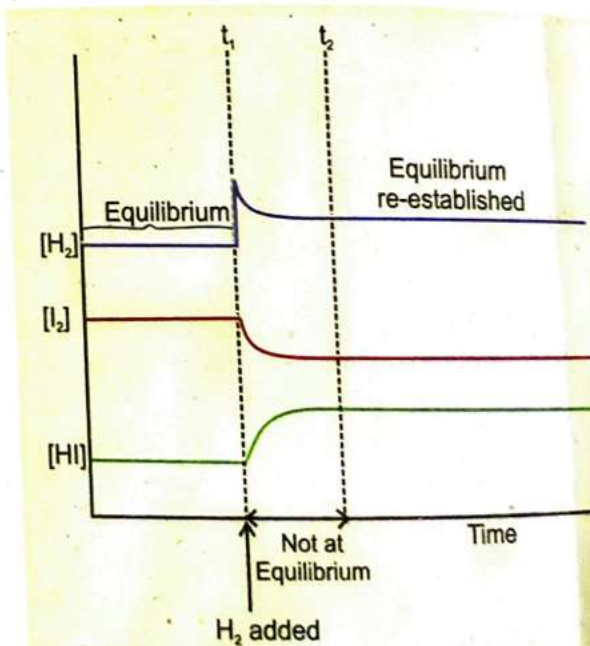


Fig. 7.8 Effect of addition of H_2 on change of concentration for the reactants and products in the reaction
 $H_2(g) + I_2(g) \rightleftharpoons 2HI(g)$

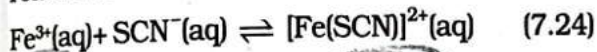
The same point can be explained in terms of the reaction quotient, Q_c ,

$$Q_c = \frac{[HI]^2}{[H_2][I_2]}$$

Addition of hydrogen at equilibrium results in value of Q_c being less than K_c . Thus, in order to attain equilibrium again reaction moves in the forward direction. Similarly, we can say that removal of a product also boosts the forward reaction and increases the concentration of the products and this has great commercial application in cases of reactions, where the product is a gas or a volatile substance. In case of manufacture of ammonia, ammonia is liquified and removed from the reaction mixture so that reaction keeps moving in forward direction. Similarly, in the large scale production of CaO (used as important building material) from CaCO_3 , constant removal of CO_2 from the kiln drives the reaction to completion. It should be remembered that continuous removal of a product maintains Q_c at a value less than K_c and reaction continues to move in the forward direction.

Effect of Concentration - An experiment

This can be demonstrated by the following reaction:



yellow colourless deep red

$$K_c = \frac{[\text{Fe}(\text{SCN})^{2+}(\text{aq})]}{[\text{Fe}^{3+}(\text{aq})][\text{SCN}^{-}(\text{aq})]} \quad (7.25)$$

A reddish colour appears on adding two drops of 0.002 M potassium thiocyanate solution to 1 mL of 0.2 M iron(III) nitrate solution due to the formation of $[\text{Fe}(\text{SCN})]^{2+}$. The intensity of the red colour becomes constant on attaining equilibrium. This equilibrium can be shifted in either forward or reverse directions depending on our choice of adding a reactant or a product. The equilibrium can be shifted in the opposite direction by adding reagents that remove Fe^{3+} or SCN^{-} ions. For example, oxalic acid ($\text{H}_2\text{C}_2\text{O}_4$), reacts with Fe^{3+} ions to form the stable complex ion $[\text{Fe}(\text{C}_2\text{O}_4)_3]^{3-}$, thus decreasing the concentration of free $\text{Fe}^{3+}(\text{aq})$. In accordance with the Le Chatelier's principle, the concentration stress of removed Fe^{3+} is relieved by dissociation of $[\text{Fe}(\text{SCN})]^{2+}$ to

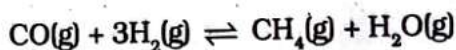
replenish the Fe^{3+} ions. Because the concentration of $[\text{Fe}(\text{SCN})]^{2+}$ decreases, the intensity of red colour decreases.

Addition of aq. HgCl_2 also decreases red colour because Hg^{2+} reacts with SCN^{-} ions to form stable complex ion $[\text{Hg}(\text{SCN})_2]^{2-}$. Removal of free $\text{SCN}^{-}(\text{aq})$ shifts the equilibrium in equation (7.24) from right to left to replenish SCN^{-} ions. Addition of potassium thiocyanate on the other hand increases the colour intensity of the solution as it shifts the equilibrium to right.

7.8.2 Effect of Pressure Change

A pressure change obtained by changing the volume can affect the yield of products in case of a gaseous reaction where the total number of moles of gaseous reactants and total number of moles of gaseous products are different. In applying Le Chatelier's principle to a heterogeneous equilibrium the effect of pressure changes on solids and liquids can be ignored because the volume (and concentration) of a solution/liquid is nearly independent of pressure.

Consider the reaction,



Here, 4 mol of gaseous reactants ($\text{CO} + 3\text{H}_2$) become 2 mol of gaseous products ($\text{CH}_4 + \text{H}_2\text{O}$). Suppose equilibrium mixture (for above reaction) kept in a cylinder fitted with a piston at constant temperature is compressed to one half of its original volume. Then, total pressure will be doubled (according to $pV = \text{constant}$). The partial pressure and therefore, concentration of reactants and products have changed and the mixture is no longer at equilibrium. The direction in which the reaction goes to re-establish equilibrium can be predicted by applying the Le Chatelier's principle. Since pressure has doubled, the equilibrium now shifts in the forward direction, a direction in which the number of moles of the gas or pressure decreases (we know pressure is proportional to moles of the gas). This can also be understood by using reaction quotient, Q_c . Let $[\text{CO}]$, $[\text{H}_2]$, $[\text{CH}_4]$ and $[\text{H}_2\text{O}]$ be the molar concentrations at equilibrium for methanation reaction. When

volume of the reaction mixture is halved, the partial pressure and the concentration are doubled. We obtain the reaction quotient by replacing each equilibrium concentration by double its value.

$$Q_c = \frac{[\text{CH}_4(\text{g})][\text{H}_2\text{O}(\text{g})]}{[\text{CO}(\text{g})][\text{H}_2(\text{g})]^3}$$

As $Q_c < K_c$, the reaction proceeds in the forward direction.

In reaction $\text{C}(\text{s}) + \text{CO}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{CO}(\text{g})$, when pressure is increased, the reaction goes in the reverse direction because the number of moles of gas increases in the forward direction.

7.8.3 Effect of Inert Gas Addition

If the volume is kept constant and an inert gas such as argon is added which does not take part in the reaction, the equilibrium remains undisturbed. It is because the addition of an inert gas at constant volume does not change the partial pressures or the molar concentrations of the substance involved in the reaction. The reaction quotient changes only if the added gas is a reactant or product involved in the reaction.

7.8.4 Effect of Temperature Change

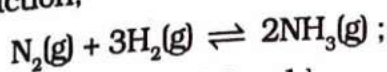
Whenever an equilibrium is disturbed by a change in the concentration, pressure or volume, the composition of the equilibrium mixture changes because the reaction quotient, Q_c no longer equals the equilibrium constant, K_c . However, when a change in temperature occurs, the value of equilibrium constant, K_c is changed.

In general, the temperature dependence of the equilibrium constant depends on the sign of ΔH for the reaction.

- The equilibrium constant for an exothermic reaction (negative ΔH) decreases as the temperature increases.
- The equilibrium constant for an endothermic reaction (positive ΔH) increases as the temperature increases.

Temperature changes affect the equilibrium constant and rates of reactions.

Production of ammonia according to the reaction,

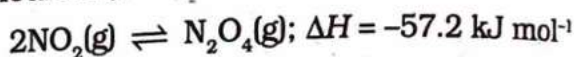


$$\Delta H = -92.38 \text{ kJ mol}^{-1}$$

is an exothermic process. According to Le Chatelier's principle, raising the temperature shifts the equilibrium to left and decreases the equilibrium concentration of ammonia. In other words, low temperature is favourable for high yield of ammonia, but practically very low temperatures slow down the reaction and thus a catalyst is used.

Effect of Temperature - An experiment

Effect of temperature on equilibrium can be demonstrated by taking NO_2 gas (brown in colour) which dimerises into N_2O_4 gas (colourless).



NO_2 gas prepared by addition of Cu turnings to conc. HNO_3 is collected in two 5 mL test tubes (ensuring same intensity of colour of gas in each tube) and stopper sealed with araldite. Three 250 mL beakers 1, 2 and 3 containing freezing mixture, water at room temperature and hot water (363K), respectively, are taken (Fig. 7.9). Both the test tubes are placed in beaker 2 for 8-10 minutes. After this one is placed in beaker 1 and the other in beaker 3. The effect of temperature on direction of reaction is depicted very well in this experiment. At low temperatures in beaker 1, the forward reaction of formation of N_2O_4 is preferred, as reaction is exothermic, and thus, intensity of brown colour due to NO_2 decreases. While in beaker 3, high temperature favours the reverse reaction of

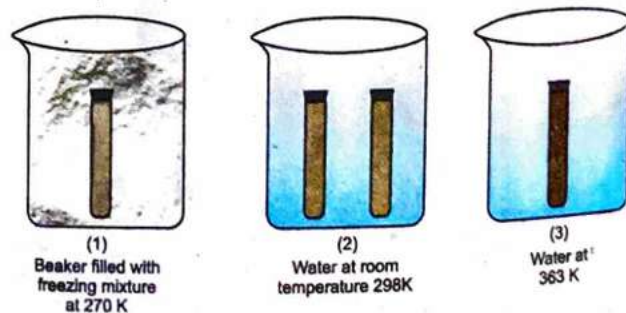
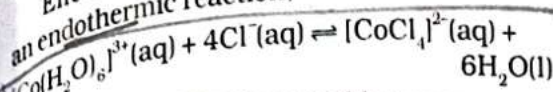


Fig. 7.9 Effect of temperature on equilibrium for the reaction, $2\text{NO}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons \text{N}_2\text{O}_4(\text{g})$

EQUILIBRIUM

formation of NO_2 and thus, the brown colour intensifies.

Effect of temperature can also be seen in an endothermic reaction,



pink colourless blue

At room temperature, the equilibrium mixture is blue due to $[\text{CoCl}_4]^{2-}$. When cooled in a freezing mixture, the colour of the mixture turns pink due to $[\text{Co}(\text{H}_2\text{O})_6]^{3+}$.

7.8.5 Effect of a Catalyst

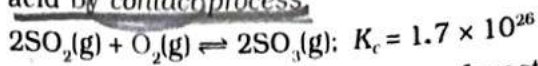
A catalyst increases the rate of the chemical reaction by making available a new low energy pathway for the conversion of reactants to products. It increases the rate of forward and reverse reactions that pass through the same transition state and does not affect equilibrium. Catalyst lowers the activation energy for the forward and reverse reactions by exactly the same amount. Catalyst does not affect the equilibrium composition of a reaction mixture. It does not appear in the balanced chemical equation or in the equilibrium constant expression.

Let us consider the formation of NH_3 from dinitrogen and dihydrogen which is highly exothermic reaction and proceeds with decrease in total number of moles formed as compared to the reactants. Equilibrium constant decreases with increase in temperature. At low temperature rate decreases and it takes long time to reach at equilibrium, whereas high temperatures give satisfactory rates but poor yields.

German chemist, Fritz Haber discovered that a catalyst consisting of iron catalyse the reaction to occur at a satisfactory rate at temperatures, where the equilibrium concentration of NH_3 is reasonably favourable. Since the number of moles formed in the reaction is less than those of reactants, the yield of NH_3 can be improved by increasing the pressure.

Optimum conditions of temperature and pressure for the synthesis of NH_3 using catalyst are around 500°C and 200 atm .

Similarly, in manufacture of sulphuric acid by contact process,

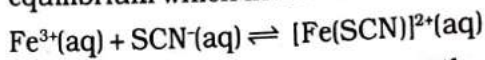


though the value of K is suggestive of reaction going to completion, but practically the oxidation of SO_2 to SO_3 is very slow. Thus, platinum or divanadium penta-oxide (V_2O_5) is used as catalyst to increase the rate of the reaction.

Note: If a reaction has an exceedingly small K , a catalyst would be of little help.

7.9 IONIC EQUILIBRIUM IN SOLUTION

Under the effect of change of concentration on the direction of equilibrium, you have incidentally come across with the following equilibrium which involves ions:



There are numerous equilibria that involve ions only. In the following sections we will study the equilibria involving ions. It is well known that the aqueous solution of sugar does not conduct electricity. However, when common salt (sodium chloride) is added to water it conducts electricity. Also, the conductance of electricity increases with an increase in concentration of common salt. Michael Faraday classified the substances into two categories based on their ability to conduct electricity. One category of substances conduct electricity in their aqueous solutions and are called electrolytes while the other do not and are thus, referred to as non-electrolytes. Faraday further classified electrolytes into strong and weak electrolytes. Strong electrolytes on dissolution in water are ionized almost completely, while the weak electrolytes are only partially dissociated. For example, an aqueous solution of sodium chloride is comprised entirely of sodium ions and chloride ions, while that of acetic acid mainly contains unionized acetic acid molecules and only some acetate ions and hydronium ions. This is because there is almost 100% ionization in case of sodium chloride as compared to less than 5% ionization of acetic acid which is a weak electrolyte. It should be noted that in weak electrolytes, equilibrium is

established between ions and the unionized molecules. This type of equilibrium involving ions in aqueous solution is called **ionic equilibrium**. Acids, bases and salts come under the category of electrolytes and may act as either strong or weak electrolytes.

7.10 ACIDS, BASES AND SALTS

Acids, bases and salts find widespread occurrence in nature. Hydrochloric acid present in the gastric juice is secreted by the lining of our stomach in a significant amount of 1.2-1.5 L/day and is essential for digestive processes. Acetic acid is known to be the main constituent of vinegar. Lemon and orange juices contain citric and ascorbic acids, and tartaric acid is found in tamarind paste. As most of the acids taste sour, the word "acid" has been derived from a latin word "acidus" meaning sour. Acids are known to turn blue litmus paper into red and liberate dihydrogen on reacting with some metals. Similarly, bases are known to turn red litmus paper blue, taste bitter and feel soapy. A common example of a base is washing soda used for washing purposes. When acids and bases are mixed in the right proportion they react with each other to give salts. Some commonly known examples of salts are sodium chloride, barium sulphate, sodium nitrate. Sodium chloride (common salt) is an important component of our diet and is formed by reaction between hydrochloric acid and sodium hydroxide. It

exists in solid state as a cluster of positively charged sodium ions and negatively charged chloride ions which are held together due to electrostatic interactions between oppositely charged species (Fig.7.10). The electrostatic forces between two charges are inversely proportional to dielectric constant of the medium. Water, a universal solvent, possesses a very high dielectric constant of 80. Thus, when sodium chloride is dissolved in water, the electrostatic interactions are reduced by a factor of 80 and this facilitates the ions to move freely in the solution. Also, they are well-separated due to hydration with water molecules.

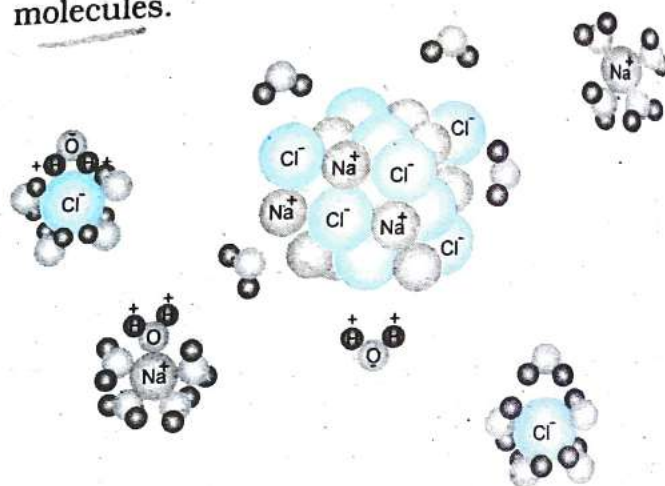


Fig. 7.10 Dissolution of sodium chloride in water. Na^+ and Cl^- ions are stabilised by their hydration with polar water molecules.

Comparing, the ionization of hydrochloric acid with that of acetic acid in water we find that though both of them are polar covalent

Faraday was born near London into a family of very limited means. At the age of 14 he was an apprentice to a kind bookbinder who allowed Faraday to read the books he was binding. Through a fortunate chance he became laboratory assistant to Davy, and during 1813-4, Faraday accompanied him to the Continent. During this trip he gained much from the experience of coming into contact with many of the leading scientists of the time. In 1825, he succeeded Davy as Director of the Royal Institution laboratories, and in 1833 he also became the first Fullerian Professor of Chemistry. Faraday's first important work was on analytical chemistry. After 1821 much of his work was on electricity and magnetism and different electromagnetic phenomena. His ideas have led to the establishment of modern field theory. He discovered his two laws of electrolysis in 1834. Faraday was a very modest and kind hearted person. He declined all honours and avoided scientific controversies. He preferred to work alone and never had any assistant. He disseminated science in a variety of ways including his Friday evening discourses, which he founded at the Royal Institution. He has been very famous for his Christmas lecture on the 'Chemical History of a Candle'. He published nearly 450 scientific papers.

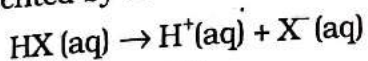


Michael Faraday
(1791-1867)

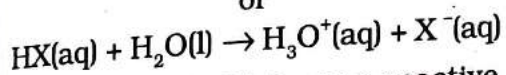
molecules, former is completely ionized into its constituent ions, while the latter is only partially ionized ($< 5\%$). The extent to which ionization occurs depends upon the strength of the bond and the extent of solvation of ions produced. The terms dissociation and ionization have earlier been used with different meaning. Dissociation refers to the process of separation of ions in water already existing as such in the solid state of the solute, as in sodium chloride. On the other hand, ionization corresponds to a process in which a neutral molecule splits into charged ions in the solution. Here, we shall not distinguish between the two and use the two terms interchangeably.

7.10.1 Arrhenius Concept of Acids and Bases

According to Arrhenius theory, acids are substances that dissociates in water to give hydrogen ions $H^+(aq)$ and bases are substances that produce hydroxyl ions $OH^-(aq)$. The ionization of an acid $HX(aq)$ can be represented by the following equations:

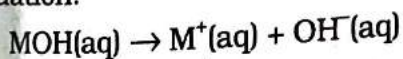


or



A bare proton, H^+ is very reactive and cannot exist freely in aqueous solutions. Thus, it bonds to the oxygen atom of a solvent water molecule to give trigonal pyramidal **hydronium ion**, H_3O^+ $[H(H_2O)]^+$ (see box). In this chapter we shall use $H^+(aq)$ and $H_3O^+(aq)$ interchangeably to mean the same i.e., a hydrated proton.

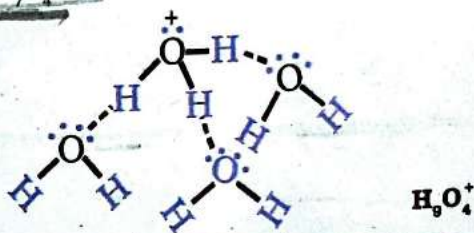
Similarly, a base molecule like MOH ionizes in aqueous solution according to the equation:



The hydroxyl ion also exists in the hydrated form in the aqueous solution. Arrhenius concept of acid and base, however, suffers from the limitation of being applicable only to aqueous solutions and also, does not account for the basicity of substances like, ammonia which do not possess a hydroxyl group.

Hydronium and Hydroxyl Ions

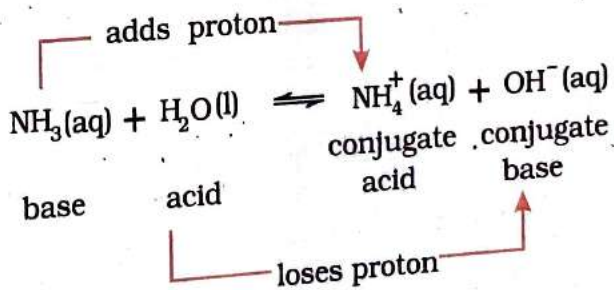
Hydrogen ion by itself is a bare proton with very small size ($\sim 10^{-15}$ m radius) and intense electric field, binds itself with the water molecule at one of the two available lone pairs on it giving H_3O^+ . This species has been detected in many compounds (e.g., $H_3O^+Cl^-$) in the solid state. In aqueous solution the hydronium ion is further hydrated to give species like $H_5O_2^+$, $H_7O_3^+$ and $H_9O_4^+$. Similarly the hydroxyl ion is hydrated to give several ionic species like $H_2O_2^-$, $H_3O_3^-$ and $H_4O_4^-$ etc.



7.10.2 The Brönsted-Lowry Acids and Bases

The Danish chemist, Johannes Brönsted and the English chemist, Thomas M. Lowry gave a more general definition of acids and bases. According to Brönsted-Lowry theory, acid is a substance that is capable of donating a hydrogen ion H^+ and bases are substances capable of accepting a hydrogen ion, H^+ . In short, acids are proton donors and bases are proton acceptors.

Consider the example of dissolution of NH_3 in H_2O represented by the following equation:



The basic solution is formed due to the presence of hydroxyl ions. In this reaction, water molecule acts as proton donor and ammonia molecule acts as proton acceptor and are thus, called Lowry-Brönsted acid and



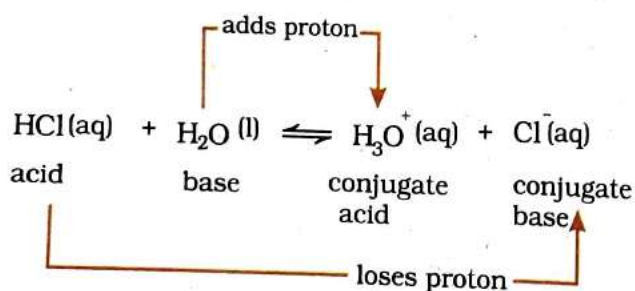
Svante Arrhenius
(1859-1927)

Arrhenius was born near Uppsala, Sweden. He presented his thesis, on the conductivities of electrolyte solutions, to the University of Uppsala in 1884. For the next five years he travelled extensively and visited a number of research centers in Europe. In 1895 he was appointed professor of physics at the newly formed University of Stockholm, serving its rector from 1897 to 1902. From 1905 until his death he was Director of physical chemistry at the Nobel Institute in Stockholm. He continued to work for many years on electrolytic solutions. In 1899 he discussed the temperature dependence of reaction rates on the basis of an equation, now usually known as Arrhenius equation.

He worked in a variety of fields, and made important contributions to immunochemistry, cosmology, the origin of life, and the causes of ice age. He was the first to discuss the 'green house effect' calling by that name. He received Nobel Prize in Chemistry in 1903 for his theory of electrolytic dissociation and its use in the development of chemistry.

base, respectively. In the reverse reaction, H^+ is transferred from NH_4^+ to OH^- . In this case, NH_4^+ acts as a Brønsted acid while OH^- acted as a Brønsted base. The acid-base pair that differs only by one proton is called a **conjugate acid-base pair**. Therefore, OH^- is called the conjugate base of an acid H_2O and NH_4^+ is called conjugate acid of the base NH_3 . If Brønsted acid is a strong acid then **its conjugate base is a weak base and vice-versa**. It may be noted that conjugate acid has one extra proton and each conjugate base has one less proton.

Consider the example of ionization of hydrochloric acid in water. $HCl(aq)$ acts as an acid by donating a proton to H_2O molecule which acts as a base.



It can be seen in the above equation, that water acts as a base because it accepts the proton. The species H_3O^+ is produced when water accepts a proton from HCl . Therefore, Cl^- is a conjugate base of HCl and HCl is the conjugate acid of base Cl^- . Similarly, H_2O is a conjugate base of an acid H_3O^+ and H_3O^+ is a conjugate acid of base H_2O .

It is interesting to observe the dual role of water as an acid and a base. In case of reaction with HCl water acts as a base while in case of

ammonia it acts as an acid by donating a proton.

Problem 7.12

What will be the conjugate bases for the following Brønsted acids: HF , H_2SO_4 and HCO_3^- ?

Solution

The conjugate bases should have one proton less in each case and therefore the corresponding conjugate bases are: F^- , HSO_4^- and CO_3^{2-} respectively.

Problem 7.13

Write the conjugate acids for the following Brønsted bases: NH_2^- , NH_3 and $HCOO^-$.

Solution

The conjugate acid should have one extra proton in each case and therefore the corresponding conjugate acids are: NH_3 , NH_4^+ and $HCOOH$ respectively.

Problem 7.14

The species: H_2O , HCO_3^- , HSO_4^- and NH_3 can act both as Brønsted acids and bases. For each case give the corresponding conjugate acid and conjugate base.

Solution

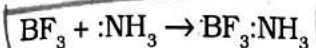
The answer is given in the following Table:

Species	Conjugate acid	Conjugate base
H_2O	H_3O^+	OH^-
HCO_3^-	H_2CO_3	CO_3^{2-}
HSO_4^-	H_2SO_4	SO_4^{2-}
NH_3	NH_4^+	NH_2^-

7.10.3 Lewis Acids and Bases

G.N. Lewis in 1923 defined an acid as a species which accepts electron pair and base which donates an electron pair. As far as bases are concerned, there is not much difference between Brønsted-Lowry and Lewis concepts, as the base provides a lone pair in both the cases. However, in Lewis concept many acids do not have proton. A typical example is reaction of electron deficient species BF_3 with NH_3 .

BF_3 does not have a proton but still acts as an acid and reacts with NH_3 by accepting its lone pair of electrons. The reaction can be represented by,



Electron deficient species like AlCl_3 , Co^{3+} , Mg^{2+} , etc. can act as Lewis acids while species like H_2O , NH_3 , OH^- etc. which can donate a pair of electrons, can act as Lewis bases.

Problem 7.15

Classify the following species into Lewis acids and Lewis bases and show how these act as such:

- (a) HO^- (b) F^- (c) H^+ (d) BCl_3

Solution

- (a) Hydroxyl ion is a Lewis base as it can donate an electron lone pair ($:\text{OH}^-$).
- (b) Fluoride ion acts as a Lewis base as it can donate any one of its four electron lone pairs.
- (c) A proton is a Lewis acid as it can accept a lone pair of electrons from bases like hydroxyl ion and fluoride ion.
- (d) BCl_3 acts as a Lewis acid as it can accept a lone pair of electrons from species like ammonia or amine molecules.

7.11 IONIZATION OF ACIDS AND BASES

Arrhenius concept of acids and bases becomes useful in case of ionization of acids and bases as mostly ionizations in chemical and biological systems occur in aqueous medium. Strong acids like perchloric acid (HClO_4),

hydrochloric acid (HCl), hydrobromic acid (HBr), hydriodic acid (HI), nitric acid (HNO_3) and sulphuric acid (H_2SO_4) are termed strong because they are almost completely dissociated into their constituent ions in an aqueous medium, thereby acting as proton (H^+) donors. Similarly, strong bases like lithium hydroxide (LiOH), sodium hydroxide (NaOH), potassium hydroxide (KOH), caesium hydroxide (CsOH) and barium hydroxide ($\text{Ba}(\text{OH})_2$) are almost completely dissociated into ions in an aqueous medium giving hydroxyl ions, OH^- . According to Arrhenius concept they are strong acids and bases as they are able to completely dissociate and produce H_3O^+ and OH^- ions respectively in the medium. Alternatively, the strength of an acid or base may also be gauged in terms of Brønsted-Lowry concept of acids and bases, wherein a strong acid means a good proton donor and a strong base implies a good proton acceptor. Consider, the acid-base dissociation equilibrium of a weak acid HA,



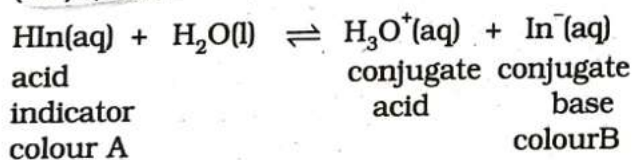
		conjugate	conjugate
acid	base	acid	base

In section 7.10.2 we saw that acid (or base) dissociation equilibrium is dynamic involving a transfer of proton in forward and reverse directions. Now, the question arises that if the equilibrium is dynamic then with passage of time which direction is favoured? What is the driving force behind it? In order to answer these questions we shall deal into the issue of comparing the strengths of the two acids (or bases) involved in the dissociation equilibrium. Consider the two acids HA and H_3O^+ present in the above mentioned acid-dissociation equilibrium. We have to see which amongst them is a stronger proton donor. Whichever exceeds in its tendency of donating a proton over the other shall be termed as the stronger acid and the equilibrium will shift in the direction of weaker acid. Say, if HA is a stronger acid than H_3O^+ , then HA will donate protons and not H_3O^+ , and the solution will mainly contain A^- and H_3O^+ ions. The equilibrium moves in the direction of formation of weaker acid and weaker base

because the stronger acid donates a proton to the stronger base.

It follows that as a strong acid dissociates completely in water, the resulting base formed would be very weak i.e., **strong acids have very weak conjugate bases.** Strong acids like perchloric acid (HClO_4), hydrochloric acid (HCl), hydrobromic acid (HBr), hydroiodic acid (HI), nitric acid (HNO_3) and sulphuric acid (H_2SO_4) will give conjugate base ions ClO_4^- , Cl^- , Br^- , I^- , NO_3^- and HSO_4^- , which are much weaker bases than H_2O . Similarly a very strong base would give a very weak conjugate acid. On the other hand, a weak acid say HA is only partially dissociated in aqueous medium and thus, the solution mainly contains undissociated HA molecules. Typical weak acids are nitrous acid (HNO_2), hydrofluoric acid (HF) and acetic acid (CH_3COOH). It should be noted that the *weak acids have very strong conjugate bases*. For example, NH_2^- , O^{2-} and H^- are very good proton acceptors and thus, much stronger bases than H_2O .

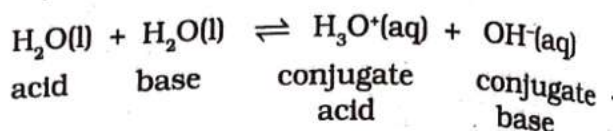
Certain water soluble organic compounds like phenolphthalein and bromothymol blue behave as weak acids and exhibit different colours in their acid (HIn) and conjugate base (In^-) forms.



Such compounds are useful as indicators in acid-base titrations, and finding out H^+ ion concentration.

7.11.1 The Ionization Constant of Water and its Ionic Product

Some substances like water are unique in their ability of acting both as an acid and a base. We have seen this in case of water in section 7.10.2. In presence of an acid, HA it accepts a proton and acts as the base while in the presence of a base, B^- it acts as an acid by donating a proton. In pure water, one H_2O molecule donates proton and acts as an acid and another water molecules accepts a proton and acts as a base at the same time. The following equilibrium exists:



The dissociation constant is represented by,

$$K = \frac{[\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{OH}^-]}{[\text{H}_2\text{O}]} \quad (7.26)$$

The concentration of water is omitted from the denominator as water is a pure liquid and its concentration remains constant. $[\text{H}_2\text{O}]$ is incorporated within the equilibrium constant to give a new constant K_w which is called the **ionic product of water.**

$$K_w = [\text{H}^+][\text{OH}^-] \quad (7.27)$$

The concentration of H^+ has been found out experimentally as $1.0 \times 10^{-7} \text{ M}$ at 298 K. And, as dissociation of water produces equal number of H^+ and OH^- ions, the concentration of hydroxyl ions, $[\text{OH}^-] = [\text{H}^+] = 1.0 \times 10^{-7} \text{ M}$. Thus, the value of K_w at 298K,

$$K_w = [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{OH}^-] = (1 \times 10^{-7})^2 = 1 \times 10^{-14} \text{ M}^2 \quad (7.28)$$

The value of K_w is temperature dependent as it is an equilibrium constant.

The density of pure water is 1000 g/L and its molar mass is 18.0 g/mol . From this the molarity of pure water can be given as,

$$[\text{H}_2\text{O}] = (1000 \text{ g/L}) / (18.0 \text{ g/mol}) = 55.55 \text{ M}$$

Therefore, the ratio of dissociated water to that of undissociated water can be given as:

$$10^{-7} / (55.55) = 1.8 \times 10^{-9} \text{ or } \sim 2 \text{ in } 10^{-9} \text{ (thus, equilibrium lies mainly towards undissociated water)}$$

We can distinguish acidic, neutral and basic aqueous solutions by the relative values of the H_3O^+ and OH^- concentrations:

$$\text{Acidic: } [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] > [\text{OH}^-]$$

$$\text{Neutral: } [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] = [\text{OH}^-]$$

$$\text{Basic: } [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] < [\text{OH}^-]$$

7.11.2 The pH Scale

Hydronium ion concentration in molarity is more conveniently expressed on a logarithmic scale known as the **pH scale**. The pH of a solution is defined as the negative logarithm to base 10 of the activity (a_{H^+}) of hydrogen

ion. In dilute solutions ($< 0.01 \text{ M}$), activity of hydrogen ion (H^+) is equal in magnitude to molarity represented by $[\text{H}^+]$. It should be noted that activity has no units and is defined as:

$$a_{\text{H}^+} = [\text{H}^+] / \text{mol L}^{-1}$$

From the definition of pH, the following can be written,

$$\text{pH} = -\log a_{\text{H}^+} = -\log ([\text{H}^+] / \text{mol L}^{-1})$$

Thus, an acidic solution of HCl (10^{-2} M) will have a $\text{pH} = 2$. Similarly, a basic solution of NaOH having $[\text{OH}^-] = 10^{-4} \text{ M}$ and $[\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] = 10^{-10} \text{ M}$ will have a $\text{pH} = 10$. At 25°C , pure water has a concentration of hydrogen ions, $[\text{H}^+] = 10^{-7} \text{ M}$. Hence, the pH of pure water is given as:

$$\text{pH} = -\log(10^{-7}) = 7$$

Acidic solutions possess a concentration of hydrogen ions, $[\text{H}^+] > 10^{-7} \text{ M}$, while basic solutions possess a concentration of hydrogen ions, $[\text{H}^+] < 10^{-7} \text{ M}$. thus, we can summarise that

Acidic solution has $\text{pH} < 7$

Basic solution has $\text{pH} > 7$

Neutral solution has $\text{pH} = 7$

Now again, consider the equation (7.28) at 298 K

$$K_w = [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{OH}^-] = 10^{-14}$$

Taking negative logarithm on both sides of equation, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} -\log K_w &= -\log ([\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{OH}^-]) \\ &= -\log [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] - \log [\text{OH}^-] \\ &= -\log 10^{-14} \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{p}K_w = \text{pH} + \text{pOH} = 14 \quad (7.29)$$

Note that although K_w may change with temperature the variations in pH with temperature are so small that we often ignore it.

$\text{p}K_w$ is a very important quantity for aqueous solutions and controls the relative concentrations of hydrogen and hydroxyl ions as their product is a constant. It should be noted that as the pH scale is logarithmic, a

change in pH by just one unit also means change in $[\text{H}^+]$ by a factor of 10. Similarly, when the hydrogen ion concentration, $[\text{H}^+]$ changes by a factor of 100, the value of pH changes by 2 units. Now you can realise why the change in pH with temperature is often ignored.

Measurement of pH of a solution is very essential as its value should be known when dealing with biological and cosmetic applications. The pH of a solution can be found roughly with the help of pH paper that has different colour in solutions of different pH . Now-a-days pH paper is available with four strips on it. The different strips have different colours (Fig. 7.11) at the same pH . The pH in the range of 1-14 can be determined with an accuracy of ~ 0.5 using pH paper.

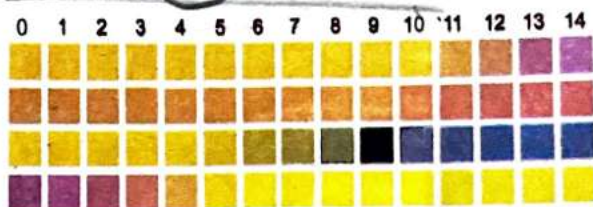


Fig. 7.11 pH -paper with four strips that may have different colours at the same pH

For greater accuracy pH meters are used. pH meter is a device that measures the pH -dependent electrical potential of the test solution within 0.001 precision. pH meters of the size of a writing pen are now available in the market. The pH of some very common substances are given in Table 7.5 (page 212).

Problem 7.16

The concentration of hydrogen ion in a sample of soft drink is $3.8 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$. what is its pH ?

Solution

$$\begin{aligned} \text{pH} &= -\log[3.8 \times 10^{-3}] \\ &= -\{\log[3.8] + \log[10^{-3}]\} \\ &= -\{(0.58) + (-3.0)\} = -\{-2.42\} = 2.42 \end{aligned}$$

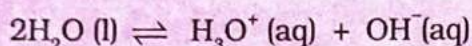
Therefore, the pH of the soft drink is 2.42 and it can be inferred that it is acidic.

Problem 7.17

Calculate pH of a $1.0 \times 10^{-8} \text{ M}$ solution of HCl .

Table 7.5 The pH of Some Common Substances

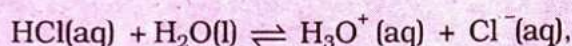
Name of the Fluid	pH	Name of the Fluid	pH
Saturated solution of NaOH	~15	Black Coffee	5.0
0.1 M NaOH solution	13	Tomato juice	~4.2
Lime water	10.5	Soft drinks and vinegar	~3.0
Milk of magnesia	10	Lemon juice	~2.2
Egg white, sea water	7.8	Gastric juice	~1.2
Human blood	7.4	1M HCl solution	~0
Milk	6.8	Concentrated HCl	~-1.0
Human Saliva	6.4		

Solution

$$K_w = [\text{OH}^-][\text{H}_3\text{O}^+]$$

$$= 10^{-14}$$

Let, $x = [\text{OH}^-] = [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+]$ from H_2O . The H_3O^+ concentration is generated (i) from the ionization of HCl dissolved i.e.,



and (ii) from ionization of H_2O . In these very dilute solutions, both sources of H_3O^+ must be considered:

$$[\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] = 10^{-8} + x$$

$$K_w = (10^{-8} + x)(x) = 10^{-14}$$

$$\text{or } x^2 + 10^{-8}x - 10^{-14} = 0$$

$$[\text{OH}^-] = x = 9.5 \times 10^{-8}$$

$$\text{So, pOH} = 7.02 \text{ and pH} = 6.98$$

constant for the above discussed acid-dissociation equilibrium:

$$K_a = c^2\alpha^2 / c(1-\alpha) = c\alpha^2 / 1-\alpha$$

K_a is called the **dissociation or ionization constant** of acid HX. It can be represented alternatively in terms of molar concentration as follows,

$$K_a = [\text{H}^+][\text{X}^-] / [\text{HX}] \quad (7.30)$$

At a given temperature T , K_a is a measure of the strength of the acid HX i.e., larger the value of K_a , the stronger is the acid. K_a is a dimensionless quantity with the understanding that the standard state concentration of all species is 1M.

The values of the ionization constants of some selected weak acids are given in Table 7.6.

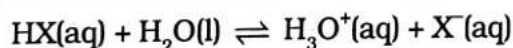
Table 7.6 The Ionization Constants of Some Selected Weak Acids (at 298K)

Acid	Ionization Constant, K_a
Hydrofluoric Acid (HF)	3.5×10^{-4}
Nitrous Acid (HNO_2)	4.5×10^{-4}
Formic Acid (HCOOH)	1.8×10^{-4}
Niacin ($\text{C}_5\text{H}_4\text{NCOOH}$)	1.5×10^{-5}
Acetic Acid (CH_3COOH)	1.74×10^{-5}
Benzoic Acid ($\text{C}_6\text{H}_5\text{COOH}$)	6.5×10^{-5}
Hypochlorous Acid (HClO)	3.0×10^{-8}
Hydrocyanic Acid (HCN)	4.9×10^{-10}
Phenol ($\text{C}_6\text{H}_5\text{OH}$)	1.3×10^{-10}

The pH scale for the hydrogen ion concentration has been so useful that besides $\text{p}K_w$, it has been extended to other species and

7.11.3 Ionization Constants of Weak Acids

Consider a weak acid HX that is partially ionized in the aqueous solution. The equilibrium can be expressed by:



Initial concentration (M)

$$c \qquad 0 \qquad 0$$

Let α be the extent of ionization

Change (M)

$$-c\alpha \qquad +c\alpha \qquad +c\alpha$$

Equilibrium concentration (M)

$$c-c\alpha \qquad c\alpha \qquad c\alpha$$

Here, c = initial concentration of the undissociated acid, HX at time, $t = 0$. α = extent up to which HX is ionized into ions. Using these notations, we can derive the equilibrium

quantities. Thus, we have:

$$pK_a = -\log(K_a) \quad (7.31)$$

Knowing the ionization constant, K_a of an acid and its initial concentration, c , it is possible to calculate the equilibrium concentration of all species and also the degree of ionization of the acid and the pH of the solution.

A general step-wise approach can be adopted to evaluate the pH of the weak electrolyte as follows:

Step 1. The species present before dissociation are identified as Brønsted-Lowry acids / bases.

Step 2. Balanced equations for all possible reactions i.e., with a species acting both as acid as well as base are written.

Step 3. The reaction with the higher K_a is identified as the primary reaction whilst the other is a subsidiary reaction.

Step 4. Enlist in a tabular form the following values for each of the species in the primary reaction

- Initial concentration, c .
- Change in concentration on proceeding to equilibrium in terms of α , degree of ionization.
- Equilibrium concentration.

Step 5. Substitute equilibrium concentrations into equilibrium constant equation for principal reaction and solve for α .

Step 6. Calculate the concentration of species in principal reaction.

Step 7. Calculate $pH = -\log[H_3O^+]$

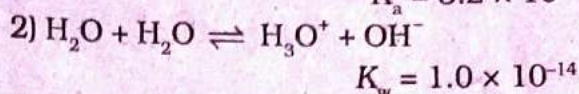
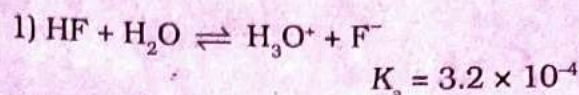
The above mentioned methodology has been elucidated in the following examples.

Problem 7.18

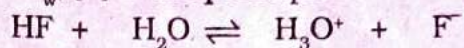
The ionization constant of HF is 3.2×10^{-4} . Calculate the degree of dissociation of HF in its 0.02 M solution. Calculate the concentration of all species present (H_3O^+ , F^- and HF) in the solution and its pH.

Solution

The following proton transfer reactions are possible:



As $K_a \gg K_w$, [1] is the principle reaction.



Initial concentration (M)			
0.02	0	0	
Change (M)			
-0.02 α	+0.02 α	+0.02 α	
Equilibrium concentration (M)			
0.02 - 0.02 α	0.02 α	0.02 α	

Substituting equilibrium concentrations in the equilibrium reaction for principal reaction gives:

$$K_a = (0.02\alpha)^2 / (0.02 - 0.02\alpha) \\ = 0.02 \alpha^2 / (1 - \alpha) = 3.2 \times 10^{-4}$$

We obtain the following quadratic equation:

$$\alpha^2 + 1.6 \times 10^{-2}\alpha - 1.6 \times 10^{-2} = 0$$

The quadratic equation in α can be solved and the two values of the roots are:

$$\alpha = +0.12 \text{ and } -0.12$$

The negative root is not acceptable and hence,

$$\alpha = 0.12$$

This means that the degree of ionization, $\alpha = 0.12$, then equilibrium concentrations of other species viz., HF, F^- and H_3O^+ are given by:

$$[H_3O^+] = [F^-] = c\alpha = 0.02 \times 0.12 \\ = 2.4 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$$

$$[HF] = c(1 - \alpha) = 0.02 (1 - 0.12) \\ = 17.6 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$$

$$pH = -\log[H^+] = -\log(2.4 \times 10^{-3}) = 2.62$$

Problem 7.19

The pH of 0.1M monobasic acid is 4.50. Calculate the concentration of species H^+ ,

A⁻ and HA at equilibrium. Also, determine the value of K_a and pK_a of the monobasic acid.

Solution

$$pH = -\log [H^+]$$

$$\text{Therefore, } [H^+] = 10^{-pH} = 10^{-4.50}$$

$$= 3.16 \times 10^{-5}$$

$$[H^+] = [A^-] = 3.16 \times 10^{-5}$$

$$\text{Thus, } K_a = [H^+][A^-] / [HA]$$

$$[HA]_{\text{eqbm}} = 0.1 - (3.16 \times 10^{-5}) \approx 0.1$$

$$K_a = (3.16 \times 10^{-5})^2 / 0.1 = 1.0 \times 10^{-8}$$

$$pK_a = -\log(10^{-8}) = 8$$

Alternatively, "Percent dissociation" is another useful method for measure of strength of a weak acid and is given as:

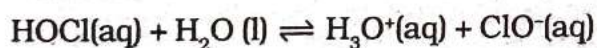
Percent dissociation

$$= [HA]_{\text{dissociated}} / [HA]_{\text{initial}} \times 100\% \quad (7.32)$$

Problem 7.20

Calculate the pH of 0.08M solution of hypochlorous acid, HOCl. The ionization constant of the acid is 2.5×10^{-5} . Determine the percent dissociation of HOCl.

Solution



Initial concentration (M)

$$0.08 \qquad \qquad \qquad 0 \qquad \qquad 0$$

Change to reach
equilibrium concentration
(M)

$$-x \qquad \qquad \qquad +x \qquad \qquad +x$$

equilibrium concentration (M)

$$0.08 - x \qquad \qquad \qquad x \qquad \qquad x$$

$$K_a = \frac{[H_3O^+][ClO^-]}{[HOCl]}$$

$$= x^2 / (0.08 - x)$$

As $x \ll 0.08$, therefore $0.08 - x \approx 0.08$

$$x^2 / 0.08 = 2.5 \times 10^{-5}$$

$$x^2 = 2.0 \times 10^{-6}, \text{ thus, } x = 1.41 \times 10^{-3}$$

$$[H^+] = 1.41 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M.}$$

Therefore,

Percent dissociation

$$= \frac{[HOCl]_{\text{dissociated}}}{[HOCl]_{\text{initial}}} \times 100$$

$$= 1.41 \times 10^{-3} \times 10^2 / 0.08 = 1.76 \%$$

$$pH = -\log(1.41 \times 10^{-3}) = 2.85.$$

7.11.4 Ionization of Weak Bases

The ionization of base MOH can be represented by equation:



In a weak base there is partial ionization of MOH into M^+ and OH^- , the case is similar to that of acid-dissociation equilibrium. The equilibrium constant for base ionization is called **base ionization constant** and is represented by K_b . It can be expressed in terms of concentration in molarity of various species in equilibrium by the following equation:

$$K_b = \frac{[M^+][OH^-]}{[MOH]} \quad (7.33)$$

Alternatively, if c = initial concentration of base and α = degree of ionization of base i.e. the extent to which the base ionizes. When equilibrium is reached, the equilibrium constant can be written as:

$$K_b = (c\alpha)^2 / c(1-\alpha) = c\alpha^2 / (1-\alpha)$$

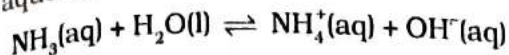
The values of the ionization constants of some selected weak bases, K_b are given in Table 7.7.

Table 7.7 The Values of the Ionization Constant of Some Weak Bases at 298 K

Base	K_b
Dimethylamine, $(CH_3)_2NH$	5.4×10^{-4}
Triethylamine, $(C_2H_5)_3N$	6.45×10^{-5}
Ammonia, NH_3 or NH_4OH	1.77×10^{-5}
Quinine, (A plant product)	1.10×10^{-6}
Pyridine, C_5H_5N	1.77×10^{-9}
Aniline, $C_6H_5NH_2$	4.27×10^{-10}
Urea, $CO(NH_2)_2$	1.3×10^{-14}

Many organic compounds like amines are weak bases. Amines are derivatives of ammonia in which one or more hydrogen atoms are replaced by another group. For example, methylamine, codeine, quinine and

nicotine all behave as very weak bases due to their very small K_b . Ammonia produces OH^- in aqueous solution:



The pH scale for the hydrogen ion concentration has been extended to get:

$$\text{p}K_b = -\log(K_b) \quad (7.34)$$

Problem 7.21

The pH of 0.004M hydrazine solution is 9.7. Calculate its ionization constant K_b and $\text{p}K_b$.

Solution



From the pH we can calculate the hydrogen ion concentration. Knowing hydrogen ion concentration and the ionic product of water we can calculate the concentration of hydroxyl ions. Thus we have:

$$[\text{H}^+] = \text{antilog}(-\text{pH})$$

$$= \text{antilog}(-9.7) = 1.67 \times 10^{-10}$$

$$[\text{OH}^-] = K_w / [\text{H}^+] = 1 \times 10^{-14} / 1.67 \times 10^{-10} = 5.98 \times 10^{-5}$$

The concentration of the corresponding hydrazinium ion is also the same as that of hydroxyl ion. The concentration of both these ions is very small so the concentration of the undissociated base can be taken equal to 0.004M.

Thus,

$$K_b = [\text{NH}_2\text{NH}_3^+][\text{OH}^-] / [\text{NH}_2\text{NH}_2]$$

$$= (5.98 \times 10^{-5})^2 / 0.004 = 8.96 \times 10^{-7}$$

$$\text{p}K_b = -\log K_b = -\log(8.96 \times 10^{-7}) = 6.04.$$

Problem 7.22

Calculate the pH of the solution in which 0.2M NH_4Cl and 0.1M NH_3 are present. The $\text{p}K_b$ of ammonia solution is 4.75.

Solution



The ionization constant of NH_3 ,

$$K_b = \text{antilog}(-\text{p}K_b) \text{ i.e.}$$

$$K_b = 10^{-4.75}$$

$$1 - x$$

$$0.004$$

$$K_b = 10^{-4.75} = 1.77 \times 10^{-5} \text{ M}$$



Initial concentration (M)

$$0.10 \quad 0.20 \quad 0$$

Change to reach

equilibrium (M)

$$-x \quad +x \quad +x$$

At equilibrium (M)

$$0.10 - x \quad 0.20 + x \quad x$$

$$K_b = [\text{NH}_4^+][\text{OH}^-] / [\text{NH}_3]$$

$$= (0.20 + x)(x) / (0.10 - x) = 1.77 \times 10^{-5}$$

As K_b is small, we can neglect x in comparison to 0.1M and 0.2M. Thus,

$$[\text{OH}^-] = x = 0.88 \times 10^{-5}$$

$$\text{Therefore, } [\text{H}^+] = 1.12 \times 10^{-9}$$

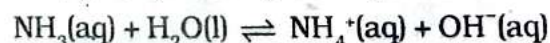
$$\text{pH} = -\log[\text{H}^+] = 8.95.$$

7.11.5 Relation between K_a and K_b

As seen earlier in this chapter, K_a and K_b represent the strength of an acid and a base, respectively. In case of a conjugate acid-base pair, they are related in a simple manner so that if one is known, the other can be deduced. Considering the example of NH_4^+ and NH_3 we see,



$$K_a = [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{NH}_3] / [\text{NH}_4^+] = 5.6 \times 10^{-10}$$



$$K_b = [\text{NH}_4^+][\text{OH}^-] / [\text{NH}_3] = 1.8 \times 10^{-5}$$



$$K_w = [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{OH}^-] = 1.0 \times 10^{-14} \text{ M}$$

Where, K_a represents the strength of NH_4^+ as an acid and K_b represents the strength of NH_3 as a base.

It can be seen from the net reaction that the equilibrium constant is equal to the product of equilibrium constants K_a and K_b for the reactions added. Thus,

$$K_a \times K_b = ([\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{NH}_3] / [\text{NH}_4^+]) \times ([\text{NH}_4^+][\text{OH}^-] / [\text{NH}_3])$$

$$= [\text{H}_3\text{O}^+][\text{OH}^-] = K_w$$

$$= (5.6 \times 10^{-10}) \times (1.8 \times 10^{-5}) = 1.0 \times 10^{-14} \text{ M}$$

This can be extended to make a generalisation. **The equilibrium constant for a net reaction obtained after adding two (or more) reactions equals the product of the equilibrium constants for individual reactions:**

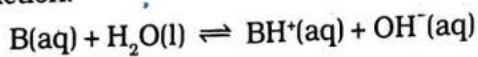
$$K_{\text{NET}} = K_1 \times K_2 \times \dots \quad (3.35)$$

Similarly, in case of a conjugate acid-base pair,

$$* \quad K_a \times K_b = K_w \quad (7.36)$$

Knowing one, the other can be obtained. It should be noted that a strong acid will have a weak conjugate base and vice-versa.

Alternatively, the above expression $K_w = K_a \times K_b$, can also be obtained by considering the base-dissociation equilibrium reaction:



$$K_b = [BH^+][OH^-] / [B]$$

As the concentration of water remains constant it has been omitted from the denominator and incorporated within the dissociation constant. Then multiplying and dividing the above expression by $[H^+]$, we get:

$$K_b = [BH^+][OH^-][H^+] / [B][H^+]$$

$$= [OH^-][H^+][BH^+] / [B][H^+]$$

$$= K_w / K_a$$

$$\text{or } K_a \times K_b = K_w$$

It may be noted that if we take negative logarithm of both sides of the equation, then pK values of the conjugate acid and base are related to each other by the equation:

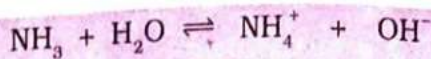
$$pK_a + pK_b = pK_w = 14 \quad (\text{at } 298K)$$

Problem 7.23

Determine the degree of ionization and pH of a 0.05M of ammonia solution. The ionization constant of ammonia can be taken from Table 7.7. Also, calculate the ionization constant of the conjugate acid of ammonia.

Solution

The ionization of NH_3 in water is represented by equation:



We use equation (7.33) to calculate hydroxyl ion concentration,

$$[OH^-] = c \alpha = 0.05 \alpha$$

$$K_b = 0.05 \alpha^2 / (1 - \alpha)$$

The value of α is small, therefore the quadratic equation can be simplified by neglecting α in comparison to 1 in the denominator on right hand side of the equation,

Thus,

$$K_b = c \alpha^2 \quad \text{or} \quad \alpha = \sqrt{(1.77 \times 10^{-5} / 0.05)} = 0.018.$$

$$[OH^-] = c \alpha = 0.05 \times 0.018 = 9.4 \times 10^{-4} M.$$

$$[H^+] = K_w / [OH^-] = 10^{-14} / (9.4 \times 10^{-4}) = 1.06 \times 10^{-11}$$

$$pH = -\log(1.06 \times 10^{-11}) = 10.97.$$

Now, using the relation for conjugate acid-base pair,

$$K_a \times K_b = K_w$$

using the value of K_b of NH_3 from Table 7.7.

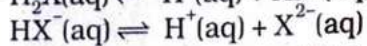
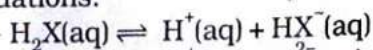
We can determine the concentration of conjugate acid NH_4^+

$$K_a = K_w / K_b = 10^{-14} / 1.77 \times 10^{-5} = 5.64 \times 10^{-10}.$$

7.11.6 Di- and Polybasic Acids and Di- and Polyacidic Bases

Some of the acids like oxalic acid, sulphuric acid and phosphoric acids have more than one ionizable proton per molecule of the acid. Such acids are known as polybasic or polyprotic acids.

The ionization reactions for example for a dibasic acid H_2X are represented by the equations:



And the corresponding equilibrium constants are given below:

$$K_{a_1} = [H^+][HX^-] / [H_2X] \text{ and}$$

$$K_{a_2} = \frac{[H^+][X^{2-}]}{[HX^-]}$$

Here, K_{a_1} and K_{a_2} are called the first and second ionization constants respectively of the acid H_2X . Similarly, for tribasic acids like H_3PO_4 , we have three ionization constants. The values of the ionization constants for some common polyprotic acids are given in Table 7.8.

Table 7.8 The Ionization Constants of Some Common Polyprotic Acids (298K)

Acid	K_{a_1}	K_{a_2}	K_{a_3}
Oxalic Acid	5.9×10^{-2}	6.4×10^{-5}	
Ascorbic Acid	7.4×10^{-4}	1.6×10^{-12}	
Sulphurous Acid	1.7×10^{-2}	6.4×10^{-8}	
Sulphuric Acid	Very large	1.2×10^{-2}	
Carbonic Acid	4.3×10^{-7}	5.6×10^{-11}	
Citric Acid	7.4×10^{-4}	1.7×10^{-5}	4.0×10^{-7}
Phosphoric Acid	7.5×10^{-3}	6.2×10^{-8}	4.2×10^{-13}

It can be seen that higher order ionization constants (K_{a_2}, K_{a_3}) are smaller than the lower order ionization constant (K_{a_1}) of a polyprotic acid. The reason for this is that it is more difficult to remove a positively charged proton from a negative ion due to electrostatic forces. This can be seen in the case of removing a proton from the uncharged H_2CO_3 as compared from a negatively charged HCO_3^- . Similarly, it is more difficult to remove a proton from a doubly charged HPO_4^{2-} anion as compared to $H_2PO_4^-$.

Polyprotic acid solutions contain a mixture of acids like H_2A , HA^- and A^{2-} in case of a diprotic acid. H_2A being a strong acid, the primary reaction involves the dissociation of H_2A , and H_3O^+ in the solution comes mainly from the first dissociation step.

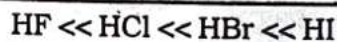
7.11.7 Factors Affecting Acid Strength

Having discussed quantitatively the strengths of acids and bases, we come to a stage where we can calculate the pH of a given acid solution. But, the curiosity rises about why should some acids be stronger than others? What factors are responsible for making them stronger? The answer lies in its being a complex phenomenon. But, broadly speaking we can say that the extent of dissociation of an acid depends on the **strength and polarity** of the H-A bond.

In general, when strength of H-A bond decreases, that is, the energy required to break the bond decreases, HA becomes a stronger acid. Also, when the H-A bond becomes more polar i.e., the electronegativity difference between the atoms H and A increases and there is marked charge separation, cleavage of the bond becomes easier thereby increasing the acidity.

But it should be noted that while comparing elements in the same group of the periodic table, H-A bond strength is a more important factor in determining acidity than its polar nature. As the size of A increases down the group, H-A bond strength decreases and so the acid strength increases. For example,

Size increases $\rightarrow$

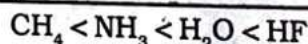


Acid strength increases $\rightarrow$

Similarly, H_2S is stronger acid than H_2O .

But, when we discuss elements in the same row of the periodic table, H-A bond polarity becomes the deciding factor for determining the acid strength. As the electronegativity of A increases, the strength of the acid also increases. For example,

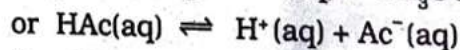
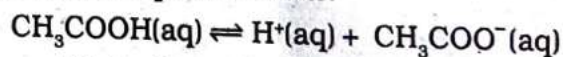
Electronegativity of A increases $\rightarrow$



Acid strength increases $\rightarrow$

7.11.8 Common Ion Effect in the Ionization of Acids and Bases

Consider an example of acetic acid dissociation equilibrium represented as:

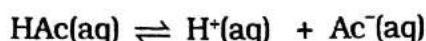


$$K_a = \frac{[H^+][Ac^-]}{[HAc]}$$

Addition of acetate ions to an acetic acid solution results in decreasing the concentration of hydrogen ions, $[H^+]$. Also, if H^+ ions are added from an external source then the equilibrium moves in the direction of undissociated acetic acid i.e., in a direction of reducing the concentration of hydrogen ions, $[H^+]$. This phenomenon is an example of

common ion effect. It can be defined as a shift in equilibrium on adding a substance that provides more of an ionic species already present in the dissociation equilibrium. Thus, we can say that common ion effect is a phenomenon based on the Le Chatelier's principle discussed in section 7.8.

In order to evaluate the pH of the solution resulting on addition of 0.05M acetate ion to 0.05M acetic acid solution, we shall consider the acetic acid dissociation equilibrium once again,



Initial concentration (M)

$$0.05 \quad 0 \quad 0.05$$

Let x be the extent of ionization of acetic acid.

Change in concentration (M)

$$-x \quad +x \quad +x$$

Equilibrium concentration (M)

$$0.05-x \quad x \quad 0.05+x$$

Therefore,

$$K_a = [\text{H}^+][\text{Ac}^-] / [\text{HAc}] = \{(0.05+x)(x)\} / (0.05-x)$$

As K_a is small for a very weak acid, $x \ll 0.05$.

$$\text{Hence, } (0.05 + x) \approx (0.05 - x) \approx 0.05$$

Thus,

$$1.8 \times 10^{-5} = (x)(0.05 + x) / (0.05 - x)$$

$$= x(0.05) / (0.05) = x = [\text{H}^+] = 1.8 \times 10^{-5} \text{ M}$$

$$\text{pH} = -\log(1.8 \times 10^{-5}) = 4.74$$

Problem 7.24

Calculate the pH of a 0.10M ammonia solution. Calculate the pH after 50.0 mL of this solution is treated with 25.0 mL of 0.10M HCl. The dissociation constant of ammonia, $K_b = 1.77 \times 10^{-5}$

Solution



$$K_b = [\text{NH}_4^+][\text{OH}^-] / [\text{NH}_3] = 1.77 \times 10^{-5}$$

Before neutralization,

$$[\text{NH}_4^+] = [\text{OH}^-] = x$$

$$[\text{NH}_3] = 0.10 - x \approx 0.10$$

$$x^2 / 0.10 = 1.77 \times 10^{-5}$$

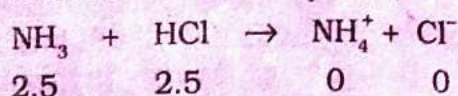
$$\text{Thus, } x = 1.33 \times 10^{-3} = [\text{OH}^-]$$

$$\text{Therefore, } [\text{H}^+] = K_w / [\text{OH}^-] = 10^{-14} /$$

$$(1.33 \times 10^{-3}) = 7.51 \times 10^{-12}$$

$$\text{pH} = -\log(7.5 \times 10^{-12}) = 11.12$$

On addition of 25 mL of 0.1M HCl solution (i.e., 2.5 mmol of HCl) to 50 mL of 0.1M ammonia solution (i.e., 5 mmol of NH_3), 2.5 mmol of ammonia molecules are neutralized. The resulting 75 mL solution contains the remaining unneutralized 2.5 mmol of NH_3 molecules and 2.5 mmol of NH_4^+ .

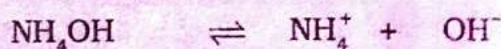


$$2.5 \quad 2.5 \quad 0 \quad 0$$

At equilibrium

$$0 \quad 0 \quad 2.5 \quad 2.5$$

The resulting 75 mL of solution contains 2.5 mmol of NH_4^+ ions (i.e., 0.033 M) and 2.5 mmol (i.e., 0.033 M) of unneutralised NH_3 molecules. This NH_3 exists in the following equilibrium:



$$0.033\text{M} - y \quad y \quad y$$

$$\text{where, } y = [\text{OH}^-] = [\text{NH}_4^+]$$

The final 75 mL solution after neutralisation already contains 2.5 mmol NH_4^+ ions (i.e. 0.033M), thus total concentration of NH_4^+ ions is given as:

$$[\text{NH}_4^+] = 0.033 + y$$

As y is small, $[\text{NH}_4\text{OH}] \approx 0.033 \text{ M}$ and $[\text{NH}_4^+] = 0.033 \text{ M}$.

We know,

$$K_b = [\text{NH}_4^+][\text{OH}^-] / [\text{NH}_4\text{OH}]$$

$$= y(0.033) / (0.033) = 1.77 \times 10^{-5} \text{ M}$$

$$\text{Thus, } y = 1.77 \times 10^{-5} = [\text{OH}^-]$$

$$[\text{H}^+] = 10^{-14} / 1.77 \times 10^{-5} = 0.56 \times 10^{-9}$$

$$\text{Hence, pH} = 9.24$$

7.11.9 Hydrolysis of Salts and the pH of their Solutions

Salts formed by the reactions between acids and bases in definite proportions, undergo ionization in water. The cations/anions form

on ionization of salts either exist as hydrated ions in aqueous solutions or interact with water to reform corresponding acids/bases depending upon the nature of salts. The later process of interaction between water and cations/anions or both of salts is called hydrolysis. The pH of the solution gets affected by this interaction. The cations (e.g., Na^+ , K^+ , Ca^{2+} , Ba^{2+} , etc.) of strong bases and anions (e.g., Cl^- , Br^- , NO_3^- , ClO_4^- , etc.) of strong acids simply get hydrated but do not hydrolyse, and therefore the solutions of salts formed from strong acids and bases are neutral i.e., their pH is 7. However, the other category of salts do undergo hydrolysis.

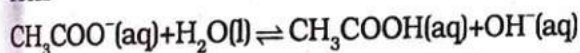
We now consider the hydrolysis of the salts of the following types :

- salts of weak acid and strong base e.g., CH_3COONa .
- salts of strong acid and weak base e.g., NH_4Cl , and
- salts of weak acid and weak base, e.g., $\text{CH}_3\text{COONH}_4$.

In the first case, CH_3COONa being a salt of weak acid, CH_3COOH and strong base, NaOH gets completely ionised in aqueous solution.

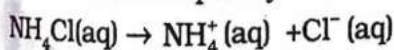
$$\text{CH}_3\text{COONa(aq)} \rightarrow \text{CH}_3\text{COO}^-(\text{aq}) + \text{Na}^+(\text{aq})$$

Acetate ion thus formed undergoes hydrolysis in water to give acetic acid and OH^- ions

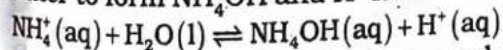


Acetic acid being a weak acid ($K_a = 1.8 \times 10^{-5}$) remains mainly unionised in solution. This results in increase of OH^- ion concentration in solution making it alkaline. The pH of such a solution is more than 7.

Similarly, NH_4Cl formed from weak base, NH_4OH and strong acid, HCl , in water dissociates completely.



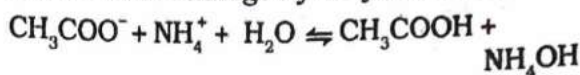
Ammonium ions undergo hydrolysis with water to form NH_4OH and H^+ ions



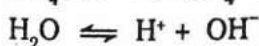
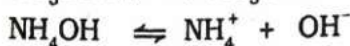
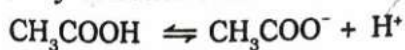
Ammonium hydroxide is a weak base ($K_b = 1.77 \times 10^{-5}$) and therefore remains almost unionised in solution. This results in

increased of H^+ ion concentration in solution making the solution acidic. Thus, the pH of NH_4Cl solution in water is less than 7.

Consider the hydrolysis of $\text{CH}_3\text{COONH}_4$ salt formed from weak acid and weak base. The ions formed undergo hydrolysis as follow:



CH_3COOH and NH_4OH , also remain into partially dissociated form:



Without going into detailed calculation, it can be said that degree of hydrolysis is independent of concentration of solution, and pH of such solutions is determined by their pK values:

$$\text{pH} = 7 + \frac{1}{2}(\text{pK}_a - \text{pK}_b) \quad (7.38)$$

The pH of solution can be greater than 7, if the difference is positive and it will be less than 7, if the difference is negative.

Problem 7.25

The pK_a of acetic acid and pK_b of ammonium hydroxide are 4.76 and 4.75 respectively. Calculate the pH of ammonium acetate solution.

Solution

$$\text{pH} = 7 + \frac{1}{2}[\text{pK}_a - \text{pK}_b]$$

$$= 7 + \frac{1}{2}[4.76 - 4.75]$$

$$= 7 + \frac{1}{2}[0.01] = 7 + 0.005 = 7.005$$

7.12 BUFFER SOLUTIONS

Many body fluids e.g., blood or urine have definite pH and any deviation in their pH indicates malfunctioning of the body. The control of pH is also very important in many chemical and biochemical processes. Many medical and cosmetic formulations require that these be kept and administered at a particular pH. The solutions which resist change in pH on dilution or with the addition of small amounts of acid or alkali are called Buffer Solutions. Buffer solutions

of known pH can be prepared from the knowledge of pK_a of the acid or pK_b of base and by controlling the ratio of the salt and acid or salt and base. A mixture of acetic acid and sodium acetate acts as buffer solution around pH 4.75 and a mixture of ammonium chloride and ammonium hydroxide acts as a buffer around pH 9.25. You will learn more about buffer solutions in higher classes.

7.13 SOLUBILITY EQUILIBRIA OF SPARINGLY SOLUBLE SALTS

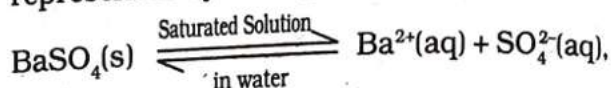
We have already known that the solubility of ionic solids in water varies a great deal. Some of these (like calcium chloride) are so soluble that they are hygroscopic in nature and even absorb water vapour from atmosphere. Others (such as lithium fluoride) have so little solubility that they are commonly termed as insoluble. The solubility depends on a number of factors important amongst which are the lattice enthalpy of the salt and the solvation enthalpy of the ions in a solution. For a salt to dissolve in a solvent the strong forces of attraction between its ions (lattice enthalpy) must be overcome by the ion-solvent interactions. The solvation enthalpy of ions is referred to in terms of solvation which is always negative i.e. energy is released in the process of solvation. The amount of solvation enthalpy depends on the nature of the solvent. In case of a non-polar (covalent) solvent, solvation enthalpy is small and hence, not sufficient to overcome lattice enthalpy of the salt. Consequently, the salt does not dissolve in non-polar solvent. As a general rule, for a salt to be able to dissolve in a particular solvent its solvation enthalpy must be greater than its lattice enthalpy so that the latter may be overcome by former. Each salt has its characteristic solubility which depends on temperature. We classify salts on the basis of their solubility in the following three categories.

Category I	Soluble	Solubility > 0.1M
Category II	Slightly Soluble	0.01M < Solubility < 0.1M
Category III	Sparingly Soluble	Solubility < 0.01M

We shall now consider the equilibrium between the sparingly soluble ionic salt and its saturated aqueous solution.

7.13.1 Solubility Product Constant

Let us now have a solid like barium sulphate in contact with its saturated aqueous solution. The equilibrium between the undissolved solid and the ions in a saturated solution can be represented by the equation:



The equilibrium constant is given by the equation:

$$K = \frac{[\text{Ba}^{2+}][\text{SO}_4^{2-}]}{[\text{BaSO}_4]}$$

For a pure solid substance the concentration remains constant and we can write

$$K_{sp} = K[\text{BaSO}_4] = [\text{Ba}^{2+}][\text{SO}_4^{2-}] \quad (7.39)$$

We call K_{sp} the solubility product constant or simply solubility product. The experimental value of K_{sp} in above equation at 298K is 1.1×10^{-10} . This means that for solid barium sulphate in equilibrium with its saturated solution, the product of the concentrations of barium and sulphate ions is equal to its solubility product constant. The concentrations of the two ions will be equal to the molar solubility of the barium sulphate. If molar solubility is S, then

$$1.1 \times 10^{-10} = (\text{S})(\text{S}) = \text{S}^2$$

$$\text{or } \text{S} = 1.05 \times 10^{-5}$$

Thus, molar solubility of barium sulphate will be equal to $1.05 \times 10^{-5} \text{ mol L}^{-1}$.

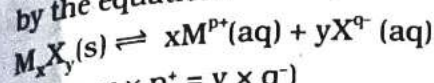
A salt may give on dissociation two or more than two anions and cations carrying different charges. For example, consider a salt like zirconium phosphate of molecular formula $(\text{Zr}^{4+})_3(\text{PO}_4^{3-})_4$. It dissociates into 3 zirconium cations of charge +4 and 4 phosphate anions of charge -3. If the molar solubility of zirconium phosphate is S, then it can be seen from the stoichiometry of the compound that

$$[\text{Zr}^{4+}] = 3\text{S} \text{ and } [\text{PO}_4^{3-}] = 4\text{S}$$

$$\text{and } K_{sp} = (3\text{S})^3 (4\text{S})^4 = 6912 (\text{S})^7$$

$$\text{or } \text{S} = \{K_{sp} / (3^3 \times 4^4)\}^{1/7} = (K_{sp} / 6912)^{1/7}$$

A solid salt of the general formula $M_x^{p+}X_y^{q-}$ with molar solubility S in equilibrium with its saturated solution may be represented by the equation:



(where $x \times p^+ = y \times q^-$)

And its solubility product constant is given

by:

$$K_{sp} = [M^{p+}]^x [X^{q-}]^y = (xS)^x (yS)^y \quad (7.40)$$

$$= x^x \cdot y^y \cdot S^{(x+y)}$$

$$S^{(x+y)} = K_{sp} / x^x \cdot y^y$$

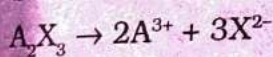
$$S = (K_{sp} / x^x \cdot y^y)^{1/(x+y)} \quad (7.41)$$

The term K_{sp} in equation is given by Q_{sp} (section 7.6.2) when the concentration of one or more species is not the concentration under equilibrium. Obviously under equilibrium conditions $K_{sp} = Q_{sp}$ but otherwise it gives the direction of the processes of precipitation or dissolution. The solubility product constants of a number of common salts at 298K are given in Table 7.9.

Problem 7.26

Calculate the solubility of A_2X_3 in pure water, assuming that neither kind of ion reacts with water. The solubility product of A_2X_3 , $K_{sp} = 1.1 \times 10^{-23}$.

Solution



$$K_{sp} = [A^{3+}]^2 [X^{2-}]^3 = 1.1 \times 10^{-23}$$

If S = solubility of A_2X_3 , then

$$[A^{3+}] = 2S; [X^{2-}] = 3S$$

$$\text{therefore, } K_{sp} = (2S)^2(3S)^3 = 108S^5$$

$$= 1.1 \times 10^{-23}$$

$$\text{thus, } S^5 = 1 \times 10^{-25}$$

$$S = 1.0 \times 10^{-5} \text{ mol/L.}$$

Problem 7.27

The values of K_{sp} of two sparingly soluble salts $Ni(OH)_2$ and $AgCN$ are 2.0×10^{-15} and 6×10^{-17} respectively. Which salt is more soluble? Explain.

Solution

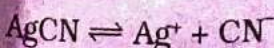
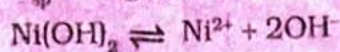


Table 7.9 The Solubility Product Constants, K_{sp} of Some Common Ionic Salts at 298K.

Name of the Salt	Formula	K_{sp}
Silver Bromide	AgBr	5.0×10^{-13}
Silver Carbonate	Ag_2CO_3	8.1×10^{-12}
Silver Chromate	Ag_2CrO_4	1.1×10^{-12}
Silver Chloride	AgCl	1.8×10^{-10}
Silver Iodide	AgI	8.3×10^{-17}
Silver Sulphate	Ag_2SO_4	1.4×10^{-5}
Aluminium Hydroxide	$Al(OH)_3$	1.3×10^{-33}
Barium Chromate	$BaCrO_4$	1.2×10^{-10}
Barium Fluoride	BaF_2	1.0×10^{-6}
Barium Sulphate	$BaSO_4$	1.1×10^{-10}
Calcium Carbonate	$CaCO_3$	2.8×10^{-9}
Calcium Fluoride	CaF_2	5.3×10^{-9}
Calcium Hydroxide	$Ca(OH)_2$	5.5×10^{-6}
Calcium Oxalate	CaC_2O_4	4.0×10^{-9}
Calcium Sulphate	$CaSO_4$	9.1×10^{-6}
Cadmium Hydroxide	$Cd(OH)_2$	2.5×10^{-14}
Cadmium Sulphide	CdS	8.0×10^{-27}
Chromic Hydroxide	$Cr(OH)_3$	6.3×10^{-31}
Cuprous Bromide	CuBr	5.3×10^{-9}
Cupric Carbonate	$CuCO_3$	1.4×10^{-10}
Cuprous Chloride	CuCl	1.7×10^{-6}
Cupric Hydroxide	$Cu(OH)_2$	2.2×10^{-20}
Cuprous Iodide	CuI	1.1×10^{-12}
Cupric Sulphide	CuS	6.3×10^{-36}
Ferrous Carbonate	$FeCO_3$	3.2×10^{-11}
Ferrous Hydroxide	$Fe(OH)_2$	8.0×10^{-16}
Ferric Hydroxide	$Fe(OH)_3$	1.0×10^{-38}
Ferrous Sulphide	FeS	6.3×10^{-18}
Mercurous Bromide	Hg_2Br_2	5.6×10^{-23}
Mercurous Chloride	Hg_2Cl_2	1.3×10^{-18}
Mercurous Iodide	Hg_2I_2	4.5×10^{-29}
Mercurous Sulphate	Hg_2SO_4	7.4×10^{-7}
Mercuric Sulphide	HgS	4.0×10^{-53}
Magnesium Carbonate	$MgCO_3$	3.5×10^{-8}
Magnesium Fluoride	MgF_2	6.5×10^{-9}
Magnesium Hydroxide	$Mg(OH)_2$	1.8×10^{-11}
Magnesium Oxalate	MgC_2O_4	7.0×10^{-7}
Manganese Carbonate	$MnCO_3$	1.8×10^{-11}
Manganese Sulphide	MnS	2.5×10^{-13}
Nickel Hydroxide	$Ni(OH)_2$	2.0×10^{-15}
Nickel Sulphide	NiS	4.7×10^{-5}
Lead Bromide	$PbBr_2$	4.0×10^{-5}
Lead Carbonate	$PbCO_3$	7.4×10^{-14}
Lead Chloride	$PbCl_2$	1.6×10^{-5}
Lead Fluoride	PbF_2	7.7×10^{-8}
Lead Hydroxide	$Pb(OH)_2$	1.2×10^{-15}
Lead Iodide	PbI_2	7.1×10^{-9}
Lead Sulphate	$PbSO_4$	1.6×10^{-8}
Lead Sulphide	PbS	8.0×10^{-28}
Stannous Hydroxide	$Sn(OH)_2$	1.4×10^{-28}
Stannous Sulphide	SnS	1.0×10^{-25}
Strontium Carbonate	$SrCO_3$	1.1×10^{-10}
Strontium Fluoride	SrF_2	2.5×10^{-9}
Strontium Sulphate	$SrSO_4$	3.2×10^{-7}
Thallous Bromide	TlBr	3.4×10^{-6}
Thallous Chloride	TlCl	1.7×10^{-4}
Thallous Iodide	TlI	6.5×10^{-8}
Zinc Carbonate	$ZnCO_3$	1.4×10^{-11}
Zinc Hydroxide	$Zn(OH)_2$	1.0×10^{-15}
Zinc Sulphide	ZnS	1.6×10^{-24}

$$K_{sp} = [\text{Ag}^+][\text{CN}^-] = 6 \times 10^{-17}$$



$$K_{sp} = [\text{Ni}^{2+}][\text{OH}^-]^2 = 2 \times 10^{-15}$$

$$\text{Let } [\text{Ag}^+] = S_1, \text{ then } [\text{CN}^-] = S_1$$

$$\text{Let } [\text{Ni}^{2+}] = S_2, \text{ then } [\text{OH}^-] = 2S_2$$

$$S_1^2 = 6 \times 10^{-17}, S_1 = 7.8 \times 10^{-9}$$

$$(S_2)(2S_2)^2 = 2 \times 10^{-15}, S_2 = 0.58 \times 10^{-4}$$

$\text{Ni}(\text{OH})_2$ is more soluble than AgCN .

7.13.2 Common Ion Effect on Solubility of Ionic Salts

It is expected from Le Chatelier's principle that if we increase the concentration of any one of the ions, it should combine with the ion of its opposite charge and some of the salt will be precipitated till once again $K_{sp} = Q_{sp}$. Similarly, if the concentration of one of the ions is decreased, more salt will dissolve to increase the concentration of both the ions till once again $K_{sp} = Q_{sp}$. This is applicable even to soluble salts like sodium chloride except that due to higher concentrations of the ions, we use their activities instead of their molarities in the expression for Q_{sp} . Thus if we take a saturated solution of sodium chloride and pass HCl gas through it, then sodium chloride is precipitated due to increased concentration (activity) of chloride ion available from the dissociation of HCl . Sodium chloride thus obtained is of very high purity and we can get rid of impurities like sodium and magnesium sulphates. The common ion effect is also used for almost complete precipitation of a particular ion as its sparingly soluble salt, with very low value of solubility product for gravimetric estimation. Thus we can precipitate silver ion as silver chloride, ferric ion as its hydroxide (or hydrated ferric oxide) and barium ion as its sulphate for quantitative estimations.

Problem 7.28

Calculate the molar solubility of $\text{Ni}(\text{OH})_2$ in 0.10 M NaOH . The ionic product of $\text{Ni}(\text{OH})_2$ is 2.0×10^{-15} .

Solution

Let the solubility of $\text{Ni}(\text{OH})_2$ be equal to S . Dissolution of S mol/L of $\text{Ni}(\text{OH})_2$ provides

S mol/L of Ni^{2+} and $2S$ mol/L of OH^- , but the total concentration of $\text{OH}^- = (0.10 + 2S)$ mol/L because the solution already contains 0.10 mol/L of OH^- from NaOH .

$$K_{sp} = 2.0 \times 10^{-15} = [\text{Ni}^{2+}][\text{OH}^-]^2 = (S)(0.10 + 2S)^2$$

As K_{sp} is small, $2S \ll 0.10$,

thus, $(0.10 + 2S) \approx 0.10$

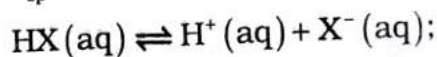
Hence,

$$2.0 \times 10^{-15} = S(0.10)^2$$

$$S = 2.0 \times 10^{-13} \text{ M} = [\text{Ni}^{2+}]$$

The solubility of salts of weak acids like phosphates increases at lower pH. This is because at lower pH the concentration of the anion decreases due to its protonation. This in turn increases the solubility of the salt so that $K_{sp} = Q_{sp}$. We have to satisfy two equilibria simultaneously i.e.,

$$K_{sp} = [\text{M}^+][\text{X}^-]$$



$$K_a = \frac{[\text{H}^+(\text{aq})][\text{X}^-(\text{aq})]}{[\text{HX}(\text{aq})]}$$

$$[\text{X}^-] / [\text{HX}] = K_a / [\text{H}^+]$$

Taking inverse of both side and adding 1 we get

$$\frac{[\text{HX}]}{[\text{X}^-]} + 1 = \frac{[\text{H}^+]}{K_a} + 1$$

$$\frac{[\text{HX}] + [\text{X}^-]}{[\text{X}^-]} = \frac{[\text{H}^+] + K_a}{K_a}$$

Now, again taking inverse, we get

$[\text{X}^-] / ([\text{X}^-] + [\text{HX}]) = f \approx K_a / (K_a + [\text{H}^+])$ and it can be seen that 'f' decreases as pH decreases. If S is the solubility of the salt at a given pH then

$$K_{sp} = [S][fS] = S^2 \{K_a / (K_a + [\text{H}^+])\} \text{ and } S = \{K_{sp} ([\text{H}^+] + K_a) / K_a\}^{1/2} \quad (7.42)$$

Thus solubility S increases with increase in $[\text{H}^+]$ or decrease in pH.